

Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle & Hunter Region Ltd

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AGM: 19th November 2003



Australia Day 2003
Citizenship Ceremony

Annual General Report

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8 Chaucer Street,
Hamilton NSW 2303

AGENDA OF THE 18TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF THE
MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE TO BE HELD ON
WEDNESDAY 19TH NOVEMBER 2003
AT 8 CHAUCER STREET, HAMILTON
AT 12 NOON.

1. OPENING AND WELCOME BY
CHAIRMAN,
MR HENRY CHAN
2. APOLOGIES
3. MINUTES OF 2002 AGM
4. BUSINESS ARISING
5. PRESENTATION OF REPORTS
6. CONFIRMATION OF AUDITORS
7. ELECTION OF MRC MANAGEMENT
COMMITTEE
8. GENERAL BUSINESS
9. CLOSE

MRC MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE MEMBERS 2002-2003

1. Chairperson	-	Henry H Chan
2. Vice Chairperson	-	William Simanowsky
3. Secretary	-	Alina Kizeweter
4. Treasurer	-	Paul Mather
5. Asst Secretary	-	Rev Fr N Zervas
6. Asst Treasurer	-	Trudy Mills-Evers
7. Member	-	Melanie Larsen
8. Member	-	Zoran Vasiljevic
9. Member	-	Ivan Klopac
10. Member	-	Sania Young
11. Member	-	Mabor Kooc

COOPTED MEMBERS

1. Department of Immigration Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs	-	Deborah Carr
2. Newcastle City Council	-	Cr Hans Tol
3. Lake Macquarie City Council	-	Cr Chris Foteff

STAFF

1. Director	-	Violetta Walsh
2. Deputy Director /Migration Agent	-	Lulu Tantos
3. Office Manager/Refugee Support	-	Tima 'Oto
4. Administrative Officer	-	Carla Silva/Mary Milevski
Administrative Casuals	-	J Hutchinson/M McGee
5. Bookkeeper	-	Arlene Richards
6. Community Project Officer/Migration Agent	-	Irina Lupish
7. Rural Support Worker- CSSS I	-	Alex Burns
8. Community Welfare Worker - CSSS II	-	Miza Torlakovic
9. Families First (Access & Equity)	-	Pat Dring
10. Program Coordinator – Productive Diversity in the Workplace (PDW)	-	Cathy Johnson
11. Filipino Welfare Worker	-	Petrona Kelly
12. Problem Gambling Support Project	-	Lisa Reardon
13. Skilled Migrant Placement Officer (SMPP)	-	Christine Follett
14. Family Support Worker	-	Marcela Sutcliffe
15. Multicultural Family Worker	-	Devika Wijewardene
16. Community Visitors' Program	-	Ann Dupree
17. Admin Assistant –PDW & SMPP	-	Antionette Gawn
18. Youth Worker	-	Rhyall Gordon / Carla Silva
19. Community Aged Package Coordinators	-	Sue Hristov / Teleisia Lolohea

SESSIONAL STAFF:

1. Pacific Islander Welfare Worker (Samoan)	-	Juanita Loli
2. Pacific Islander Welfare Worker (Tongan)	-	Teleisia Lolohea
3. Hunter Ethnic Parents Teachers Association of Community Language Schools- (Project Officer)-		Michael O'Sullivan
4. Skillmax Coordinator/s	-	Flora Menezes/Kathy Patterson

**MINUTES OF THE 17TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF THE MIGRANT
RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION LTD,
HELD AT THE MRC PREMISES ON WEDNESDAY 20TH NOVEMBER 2002
AT 11AM.**

PRESENT: As per list attached

1. H Chan welcomed everyone present on behalf of the MRC Management committee.
2. **APOLOGIES:** Lord Mayor John Tate, Newcastle City Council, Luchi Buxton & Tony Smith (Belmont Neighbourhood Centre) & Lorraine Norton.
3. Corrections to the AGM Report - 2002
4. **MINUTES OF THE 2001 AGM.**
Proposer: Zoran Vasiljevic
Seconder: Fr N Zervas
5. **BUSINESS ARISING:**
 - (i) Violetta stated that with the completion of the Families First Access and Equity project Pat Dring has finished work with the Centre. Pat has been a highly valuable member of the staff and we look forward to her continued relationship to the MRC.
6. **PRESENTATION OF REPORTS**
 - (i) **Chairperson's Report** – Report tabled and accepted as read.
 - (ii) **V Walsh –Director:** Report tabled and accepted as read.
 - (iii) **I Lupish – CPO:** Report tabled and accepted as read.
 - (iv) **A Burns: Community Settlement Services I:** Report tabled and accepted as read. He has achieved a great deal through the Rural Strategy.
 - (v) **Miza Torlokovic – Community Settlement Services II:** Report tabled and accepted as read
 - (vi) **P Dring – Families First Access and Equity:** Report tabled and accepted as read. Added that the launch of the Manual was very successful.

- (vii) **Christine Follett – Skilled Migrant Placement Program:** Report tabled and accepted as read. SMPP Package for funding has not been released. Some changes are to occur with this program.
- (viii) **M Sutcliffe – Family Welfare Support Worker** - Report tabled and accepted as read. Added that the appointment of the worker has been invaluable in supporting her role as Multicultural family support worker.
- (ix) **P Kelly – Filipino Welfare Support Worker** - Report tabled and accepted as read
- (x) **C Johnston – Coordinator, Productive Diversity in the Workplace Program** - Report tabled and accepted as read. She has enjoyed the challenge of the last 12 months and thanked everyone for their support.
- (xi) **A Dupree – Community Volunteer Scheme** - Report tabled and accepted as read. An increase of visitors to 28 Visitors was funded. She stated the need for more volunteers.
- (xii) **Community Aged Care Package – Sue Hristov and Sulu Lolohea** - Report tabled and accepted as read. Sulu thanked all the staff for helping her, and Sue added her appreciation of having the support of Sulu. She thanked Violetta and Alex for applying for this funding – very busy with clients since its start.
- (xiii) **R. Gordon - Youth Support Strategy – Report tabled and accepted as read:** Funding is coming to an end. Working with Violetta to try to access other funding for Youth projects. Violetta added that the NESB Youth area was a high need area with service delivery gaps.

Reports accepted.

Proposer: Paul Mather
Seconder: Trudy Mills-Evers

7. FINANCIAL REPORTS: Report tabled as accepted as read. Paul Mather presented the reports on behalf of the Centre

Proposer: Zoran Vasiljevic
Seconder: Michael Todd

8. APPOINTMENT OF COMPANY AUDITORS:

- (xi) Proposed by the outgoing committee that a local firm, Cutcher & Neal be appointed as the Centre's new Auditor for the coming year.
- (xii) Cutcher and Neal duly appointed.

9. Election of the MRC management. (11 nominations for 11 positions).

1. Bill Simanowsky
2. Sania Young
3. Ivan Klopčic
4. Alina Kizeweter
5. Trudy Mills-Evers
6. Zoran Vasiljevic
7. Father Nicholas Zervas
8. Melanie Larsen
9. Mabor Kooc
10. Henry Chan
11. Paul Mather

The 11 nominees were duly elected as the 2002 management committee.

10. GENERAL BUSINESS:

- (i) B Simanowsky extended his congratulations to the hard working staff of the Centre.
- (ii) Trudy Mills-Evers complimented staff of MRC for their professionalism.
- (iii) V Walsh outlined proposals from DIMIA to improve client access to immigration services by directly linking a customer hotline to DIMIA Parramatta, and offering Internet access for clients to download forms.

11. GUEST SPEAKER – The Hon Gary Hardgrave MP- Minister for Citizenship and Multicultural Affairs, Minister Assisting the Prime Minister

MEETING ENDED AT 12.00 MIDDAY.

NEXT ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING TO BE HELD ON WEDNESDAY 19TH NOVEMBER 2003 AT 12.00 NOONS.

**MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE OF THE MRC ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING
HELD ON 20/11/02**

	NAME	COMMUNITY		NAME	COMMUNITY
1.	Mabor Kooc	Sudanese	2.	Ater Dhiu	Sudanese
3.	Sura Reyak	Sudanese	4.	Trasia Agualy	Sudanese
5.	Majuong Thonjot Mabor	Sudanese	6.	Elizabeth M Mon	Sudanese
7.	Nova Lolohea	Tongan	8.	Zaga Nagy	DIMIA
9.	Samuel Tuiolemotu	Samoa	10.	Chris Papadopoulos	Pavlos Melas
11.	Michael O'Sullivan	HEPTACLS	12.	Rev Fr N Zervas	Greek Orthodox
13.	Flora Menezes	Skillmax	14.	Diana Kalan	Skillmax
15.	B Jaskiewicz	Skillmax	16.	Denise Hodgson	Centrelink
17.	Luz Koppen	Filipino	18.	Chloe Hughes	Skillmax
19.	Ian Campbell	DIMIA	20.	Arturo Diaz	Skillmax
21.	Neolita Ingermo	Skillmax	22.	V Lupish	Russian
23.	T Lolohea	Tongan/PIWC	24.	Cathy Johnston	MRC
25.	Lulu Tantos	MRC	26.	Irina Lupish	MRC
27.	Pet Kelly	MRC	28.	Deborah Carr	DIMIA
29.	Arlene Richards	MRC	30.	Ana Mose	Samoa
31.	Melipa Utai	Samoa	32.	Ann Dupree	MRC/Dutch
33.	Miza Torlakovic	MRC	34.	Paul Mather	MRC
35.	Alina Kizeweter	Polish	36.	Sania Young	Russian
37.	Galia Myszczytyn	Russian	38.	Alex Burns	MRC
39.	William Simanowsky	Ukrainian	40.	Michael Todd	Macedonian
41.	Adam Lepidis	Greek Macedonian	42.	Minister Gary Hardgrave -	DIMIA
43.	Elina Simunovic	Tongan	44.	Cr Hans Tol	NCC
45.	Christine Follett	SMPO/MRC	46.	Juanita Loli	PIWC/Samoan
47.	Lani Larsen	Filipino	48.	Trudy Mills Evers	MHU
49.	Rhyall Gordon	MRC	50.	Sue Hristov	MRC
51.	Zoran Vasiljevic	Bosnian	52.	Marcela Sutcliffe	MRC
53.	Henry Chan	Chinese	54.	Violetta Walsh	MRC
55.	Tima 'Oto	MRC	56.	Ivan Klopčič	Slovene
57.	Pat Dring	MRC	58.	Sylvie Laboudigue	France

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE

PURPOSES

- **The MRC of Newcastle is a community based not for profit organization, which has operated in the Newcastle area since its establishment, by the Federal Government in 1981.**
- **The MRC's mission is to strive for the successful integration of migrants, refugees and humanitarian entrants in the Hunter and through various projects, in outreach locations identified in the Department of Immigration and Indigenous and Multicultural Affairs' Rural Strategy being the North, North West and Central West of NSW.**

MRC OBJECTIVES

- **To deliver high quality settlement services to target group**
- **To focus on service delivery for special needs groups – refugee/humanitarian entrants, newly arrived, unemployed, aged, young people and women.**
- **To promote an environment of mutual understanding between the mainstream and ethnic communities.**
- **To provide outreach services to people of non-English Speaking Background residing in isolated and rural areas.**

Service Principles

The Hon Gary Hardgrave MP, Minister for Citizenship and Multicultural Affairs, is committed to ensuring that Migrant Resource Centres/Migrant Service Agencies provide the highest quality service, and maintain a focus on client needs.

This is supported by the *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre*.

The Minister and the *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre* endorse the following principles, which must guide the provision of quality programs and services:

1. Newly arrived migrants must have equal opportunity to realise their full potential and must have access to appropriate programs and services;
2. Every person should be able to maintain his or her culture without prejudice or disadvantage and should be encouraged to understand and embrace other cultures;
3. Needs of migrants should, in general, be met by programs and services available to the whole community but special services and programs may be necessary to ensure equality of access and provision; and
4. Services and programs should be designed and operated in full consultation with clients, and self-help should be encouraged as much as possible with a view to helping migrants to become self-reliant quickly.

The Minister and *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre* will work in partnership to implement this commitment.



Gary Hardgrave

Minister for Citizenship and
Multicultural Affairs

Date: 1 / 1 / 2002



(Henry Chen)
Chairperson of
*Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant
Resource Centre*

Date: 06/06/2002

OVERVIEW OF THE MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION

Funded Partnerships throughout 2003

Department of Immigration Multicultural and Indigenous Affairs
 NSW Department of Community Services
 NSW Department of Education and Training
 Department of Health and Ageing
 Casino Benefit Fund, NSW Dept of Gaming and Racing
 Community Relations Commission for a Multicultural NSW
 Hunter Area Assistance Scheme
 Hunter Area Health

Clients by Ethnic Background

Albania	Fiji	Malaysia	Scotland
Algeria			
Australia	Finland	Macedonia	Serbia
Austria	France	Mexico	Singapore
Argentina	Germany	Montenegro	Slovenia
Bangladesh	Greece	Morocco	South Africa
Belgium	Honduras	Mauritius	Spain
Botswana	Hong Kong	Netherlands	Sri Lanka
Bosnia	Hungary	Nepal	Sudan
Brazil	India	New Zealand	Sweden
Canada	Indonesia	Nigeria	Switzerland
Chile	Ireland	Norway	Syria
China	Iran	Panama	Tahiti
Colombia	Italy	Pakistan	Taiwan
Costa Rica	Japan	Papua New Guinea	Thailand
Croatia	Jordan	Paraguay	Tonga
Cyprus	Kazakhstan	Peru	Tunisia
Czech Republic	Kenya	Poland	Turkey
Dominican Republic	Korea	Portugal	Ukraine
East Timor	Kuwait	The Philippines	Uruguay
England	Latvia	Romania	USA
El Salvador	Lebanon	Russia	Venezuela
Egypt	Lithuania	Samoa	Vietnam

Client Statistics by program area

Tax Help	257
EAPA	1280
DIMIA PILOT Program	150

Total Centre output for 2003

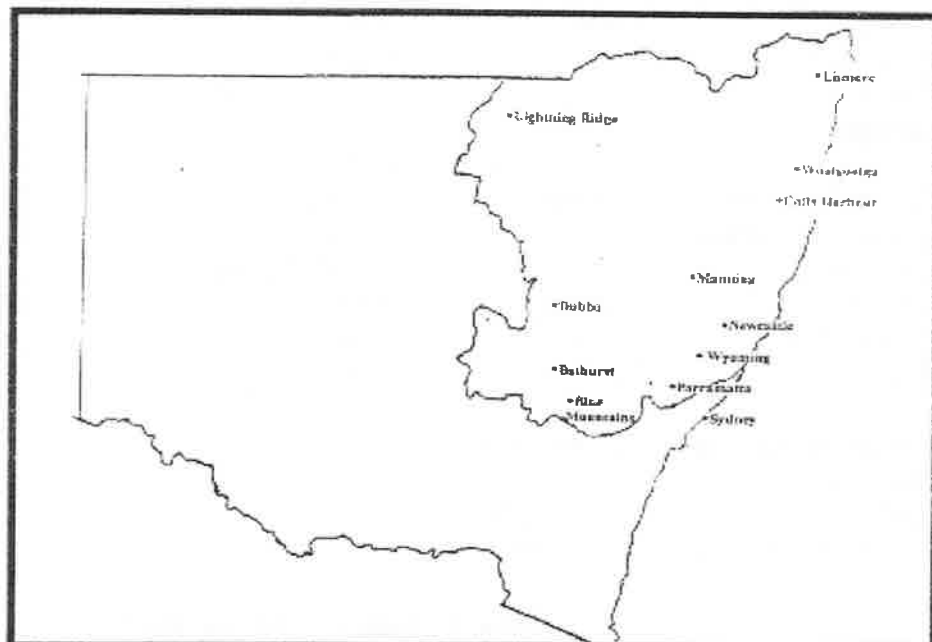
Please see individual reports for details.

OUR REGIONS

HUNTER AREA



RURAL STRATEGY AREA



CHAIRMAN'S REPORT



I am pleased to submit my report for 2003.

This is, as you are aware, a most challenging period for MRCs and settlement services in general. Of course those of us who have had a long association with this area of activity, and I count in that number, myself, many of my colleagues and our staff, have little memory of anything else but constant challenge, but clearly we are on the brink of a whole new era in the history of migrant settlement.

It is an era, which will change forever the previous relationship we have enjoyed with the Department from a funded community service partner to a business partner.

Now there are those who would say that MRCs have, for too long, had it easy, occupying a position of comfort, with core funding coming like clockwork, including, uniquely, the cost of our infrastructure.

A word on this comfort zone-it has been increasingly uncomfortable with reporting and accountability requirements tightening year by year. DIMIA has been a very vigilant, some might say draconian, master.

So all this is to be superseded by a whole new approach of bidding for the work, demonstrating above all else no doubt, value for money, as generally happens in the tendering environment. We hope that cost is not the sole consideration. We hope experience; expertise, innovation, collaboration and dedication count for something.

We really don't blow our trumpet enough and never have. But we do hold an exemplary track record in service delivery, and service and community development, hard won over the 22 years of our existence.

And not all our work is widely known.

Our clients and colleagues may not be aware, for example, that when they stand here in this Centre, they stand on a very small part of the territory we have served for over 20 years. Certainly the Hunter is our base (and it's the size of Tasmania!) but our Rural Strategy has extended our settlement activities to the far north coast of NSW, to Lightning Ridge in the North West, the Central West and the Central Coast. This has occurred at the request of the Department.

And our footprint is set to grow even bigger. In the last few weeks, we have begun the groundwork to establish new and long overdue settlement services to the New England Region, and the North West Plains.

You will be impressed I think with the range and diversity of the services we provide, as you will see in our Annual Report: information and referral, family and community welfare, education and training, employment placement, cultural competency training to mainstream providers, productive diversity promotion, and aged care, and we are grateful for the funding support we have received from seven different funding sources.

I would like to expand a little on activities we have especially focused on to meet needs in our area, and they relate specifically to the provision of immigration advice and assistance. The closing of that Immigration Office 7 years ago has not been forgotten but perhaps forgiven slightly, because of access programs that we have integrated into our work through sources other than settlement funding.

First, for the last few years we have been successful in a tender to the Department of Immigration's Onshore Protection Unit to provide a free service to eligible financially disadvantaged clients, which is provided by one of our 2 registered agents who are as it happens, second to none. We have also identified a market opportunity to offer a very competitively priced service to other clients who are not eligible for the free service, and who would need to use a commercial migration Advisory Service.

To that end we are working very cooperatively with the University of Newcastle in assisting those overseas students who are seeking permanent residency, and we are receiving substantial referrals from the Hunter Area Health Service to assist members of the overseas recruited medical workforce who are eligible to apply for permanency.

But perhaps the most exciting opportunities may be coming through our involvement in the DIMIA Electronic Information Pilot program, which has significantly improved client access to Departmental information and forms. We all suffer from Call Centre fatigue, (do we not?) so that clients' direct phone access to a human being in the Parramatta Office is a marvel in itself. The Pilot is to be extended to include Citizenship processing and interviewing, and we have been invited to submit a business plan to the Department to do this work.

Potentially, these sorts of developments will stand us in good stead as we confront the new changed funding environment for Migrant Resource Centres and settlement services, and will allow us to demonstrate that all our eggs are not simply in one basket.

So, despite the understandable nostalgia for maintaining a status quo, we must move forward with the changing policy, and continue to identify and pursue new and productive synergies with DIMIA, and with other potential partners in the pursuit of better settlement outcomes for our target group.

I know my fellow Committee Members are in agreement, and I am confident our wonderful staff will, as always, rise to the occasion. I would like to take this opportunity to thank all of them, Committee and staff alike, for their continued support and good work!

Henry Chan
Chairman

DIRECTOR'S REPORT



It is never business as usual in the MRC and it is the freshness and variety that keeps some of us here even though we're fast approaching that "use by" date.

An interesting and challenging year, no doubt at all, with both external and internal factors exerting an influence on what and how we have operated.

Inevitably, a key influence has been funding, both the anticipated from our usual sources, and the unexpected coming from successful submissions to

various funding bodies, which has allowed us to not only to continue our settlement work as required by DIMIA, but to undertake innovative projects to address identified needs in collaborative and we hope, self-sustaining ways.

The NSW Community Casino Benefit Fund has allowed us to address community information and support needs related to problem gambling, and has resulted in a positive working relationship with developed existing mainstream counselling and assistance services.

A partnership with the Hunter Area Health Service has helped us develop excellent links between the Area's Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services and young people of NESB by providing a targeted drug and alcohol prevention, education and harm minimisation program.

Additional resources from Families First Program of the Department of Community Services have given the opportunity of promoting that wonderful Access and Equity Resource Manual "We don't have any CALD clients," developed last year. Training in its application has been provided to Docs family support services and there has been enormous interest in it from a very wide range of agencies and departments, both state and federal.

The Skillmax Program, funded by AMES, has continued to operate strongly at the Centre, creating very positive results for our overseas skilled clients, and a modest but much appreciated equipment grant from Hunter Area Assistance Scheme has been used to great effect in building interview skills of recently arrived jobseekers.

Most significant and unexpected is the newest grant from DIMIA under the Community Settlement Services Scheme is a major boost to its Rural Strategy. Our task here is to develop outreach settlement services to newly arrived migrants in the New England Region of NSW, including the NW slopes, to serve such centres as Armidale and Tamworth. This is a wonderful opportunity for us to plan and implement a brand new service in a much-overlooked region.

So our geographic footprint is set to expand considerably, with most of the state north of Hornsby connected to us in one way or another. It is worth noting that overall the NESB population in our regional/rural territory is approximately 60000 and the newly arrived component, i.e 5 years or under, is a substantial **5000 settlers**.

All activities resourced by the new funds have of course been in addition to the ongoing settlement work of the Centre, the delivery of information, referral

and general welfare services, employment placement services, cultural competency training, community education, aged support services, promotion of access and equity particularly in local government, and last but not least the provision of immigration advice and assistance.

Our Chairman has described in great detail how valuable this work is to residents in our region and to this agency, and has outlined the various approaches we are taking to offer equitable professional services. It is worth noting the escalating level of annual demand, approximately 800 occasions of service face to face, and close to 2000 phone enquiries.

This year has also been marked by an unprecedented event in this region, the arrival, in significant numbers, of refugees from Sudan. At last count approximately a dozen families have arrived, having been proposed by the Sudanese here. Much of our energy and increasing resources have been focused on supporting the arrivals, the proposers and very many wonderful individuals and agencies who are rallying to assist their settlement in our town. There is much generosity here, which never ceases to uplift us.

This new group of refugees, with unique cultural and linguistic characteristics and pre-migration experiences, will take time to settle. They have many major settlement needs, information, cultural orientation, housing for generally very large families, education. Refugee settlement work, while rewarding, is also very demanding and made more so by the fact that arrival rates are quite unpredictable - a case of feast or famine.

These proposed arrivals are the precursors of a group of government sponsored refugees who are to be resettled in Newcastle, probably early in the New Year. They, like the Sudanese, will also come from African countries, and will pose considerable challenges for us to meet their needs appropriately.

We are of course used to challenge. All survivors are. In the next 2 years we will be facing the biggest of all, as we prepare to tender for this service, which, up to now, the Department has funded. It is the age of contestability and we must play by the new rules. There is too much at stake not to play, even more, not to win.

As we fast approach the end of another year, it is incumbent on me to thank my wonderful colleagues on the Committee and on staff, who really lighten my burdens. Everyone is a vital contributing part of this amazing and productive whole, and there is so much talent and commitment under this one roof. I commend to you the presentation, in this Report, of their year's work by all our staff.

And as in other years we need to say some hellos and a reluctant farewell.

A very warm welcome to Deborah Carr, our DIMIA consultant, to Lisa Reardon, our NESB Problem Gambling Support worker, and to Mary Milevski, our new receptionist, who together with Carla Silva/Bekker, (when she's not being our youth worker) represents the "face" of the Centre. Goodbye (again!) to Pat Dring, who was coaxed back to conduct a very special Access and Equity project for us.

It has been a busy year and we all look forward to a well-deserved break.

Violetta Walsh - Director.

COMMUNITY PROJECT OFFICER – 2003 ANNUAL REPORT

(Funded by the Department of Immigration & Multicultural and Indigenous Affairs)



This year, for me, has been a short but intense year. The project has been providing service to individual clients, government and non-government agencies and covering a large geographic area. Clients come from 73 different countries, presenting different needs. Our immigration service provided face-to-face assistance to 605 clients and addressed 30 different visa issues.

Immigration Information & Advice Service

Lulu Tantos and myself have conducted a total of 605 face-to-face consultations. 1730 telephone consultations were offered, 427 were contacts from Rural Region of our service area – Central Coast, Lismore, Muswellbrook, Bathurst, Byron Bay, Dungog, Armidale, Port Macquarie, Foster, Coffs Harbour, Grafton and Dorrigo. We refer you to Fig. 1 and Fig. 2 for details. Types of visas that we have been assisting with vary from simple visa application to complex and demanding submissions to the Department of Immigration, Migration Tribunal or the Minister of Immigration.

Fig 1 – provision of service to clients by migration Agents at the MRC.

Agents	Face to Face consultation	Phone Consultation
L.Tantos	374	899
I. Lupish	231	831
Total	605	1730

Fig.2 – Clients come from 73 different countries with the top 10 being:

Country of Origin	Occasions of Service (face to face & telephone)
Russia	152
China	142
Philippines	139
Poland	98
India	97
Macedonia	23
Thailand	20
Indonesia	18
Malaysia	16
Turkey	15

Austcare Refugee Week – Celebrations of Refugee week this year were during the week of 20th to 25th October. Three activities were conducted in partnership with Hunter Refugee Network and their members - on the 20th October consultation was held by STARTTS to determine the needs of

refugees in our area. Fund Day was organized at the Blackbutt Reserve and Refugee week celebration was part of the Lake Macquarie EXPO 2003. Over all about 200 people participated in all those activities.

Lake Macquarie EXPO 2003 – in partnership with the Lake Macquarie City Council EXPO was organised on the 22nd October. The General Manager opened the EXPO and 21 services provided information to the local agents on services available to them.

Outreach Work – provided information and consultation to the workers and clients in North Coast, Hunter Valley and Newcastle areas. Information session was provided to service providers and face- to- face consultations were provided to clients needing advice on Migration matters. The visit included the following areas: - Wingham, Port Macquarie, Coffs Harbour, Grafton, Lismore in the north, Cessnock, Raymond Terrace and Rutherford.

John Hunter Hospital Multicultural Week – organised stalls and ethnic choral performances were organized during the Multicultural Week. Several choirs entertained staff, visitors and patients in the foyer. It was well received by all.

Multicultural Open Day in Myuna Bay - was organized in partnership with the Department of Sport and Recreation. Communities had the opportunity to acquaint themselves with the services provided by the Department. A tour of the facilities and activities were organized for the representatives of several ethnic communities. All enjoyed the day.

Service and Community Development	Other Involvements
This project supported the following agencies: Department Community & Training Centrelink Department of Community Services Violence Against Women Project Lake Macquarie City Council Lake Macquarie Interagency Hunter Area Health Service PHD DOCS Disaster Welfare Austcare Kolbe House	Facilitate Hunter Refugee Network Facilitate Hunter Refugee Special Meetings Hunter Area Health Service Multicultural Advisory Committee Meetings Facilitate Multicultural Interagency Meetings Attended a number of special meetings, seminars, consultations and forums. Provided clerical support to this project. Attended staff and Management Committee meetings. Attended Fire Safety Training Successfully completed Continued Professional Development for re-registration as Migration Agent.

I would like to thank the staff and the Management committee for their support during the year and especially during my illness.

Irina Lupish – Community Project Officer.

2003 ANNUAL REPORT -RURAL SUPPORT CSSS WORKER

(Funded by the Department of Immigration & Multicultural and Indigenous Affairs)



The project continues to be very busy. During the year I continued to work closely with all the Rural Based CSSS projects directly through face-to-face meetings, through the rural conference process, through interagency mechanisms and through the use of IT and telephone. Particular attention was given to the more isolated projects such as Lightning Ridge and those, which had newer workers such as Manning Valley. The face-to-face visits are shown in table 1.

Table 1: Face-to-Face Visits to each Rural Based CSSS Project in 2002-2003

Project	Visits
Manning Valley	7
Coffs Harbour	4
Woolgoolga	5
Lismore	2
Newcastle/Hunter	10
Wyoming	5
Bathurst	4
Dubbo	3
Lightning Ridge	2

The most important meeting for the project was the 2003 Rural CSSS Worker Conference. The conference structure saw some changes to previous years with day 1 including a tour of DIMIA in Lee Street. The conference was also made open to other CSSS projects from other parts of Australia and this saw the attendance of people from the Southern area of NSW and the Northern Territory. The conference was a success and much appreciated by the CSSS rural based projects. Thanks go to DIMIA, and especially the Parramatta Office for its support for the rural conference.

The outcomes of this project continue to be considerable. Not only does the project provide direct support to the rural projects but it also has input into policy development and planning through work with other government organisations which this year have included, the NSW Department of Community Services at a local and state level, the Office of Fair Trading, Centrelink, NSW Department of Education and Training, DIMIA and NICOMS.

Table 2: Consultations with Various Government Agencies

Name	Consul tations	Name	Consul tations
DIMIA	12	NICOMS	2
DoCS –state	3	DoCS – regional	7
AMEP –general	7	AMEP – regional	2
AMEP – state	1	NSW Housing	1
Hunter Water	1	NSW Dep't of Education – School	2
NSW Department of Education – TAFE	1	NSW CRC	1
Transcultural Aged Care Service	2	Office of Fair Trading	1

Issues raised included interpreting, training for cross cultural and torture and trauma competencies, refugees and TPV holders and lack of following up on EAPS by regional state offices.

A number of presentations were given by the project on rural issues. These included a paper to the AMES 2003 Rural Forum titled: **“New Opportunities for Integrated Settlement Provision – July and Beyond: Successful Partnerships”**, another on the **“MRC and its work”** areas to a local AMEP forum, a workshop on **“Achieving Outcomes with State and local government agencies”** to the Centrelink 2003 Rural Conference and **“Productive Diversity in Regional NSW: Achievements and Outcomes of a Rural Project”** to the 2003 Cultural Diversity conference in Melbourne.

The general services provided by the project are listed in Table 3. As will be seen 173 individuals received advice and support outside of the work given to the rural based CSSS projects. While numbers of these services were to newly arrived migrants the bulk of other individual support was to service providers seeking to make contact with new arrivals or to improve access to their services.

Table 3 Services Provided

Face to Face Services with Clients	Telephone Services	Group Work
173	674	136 group sessions– number of group participants 1938

Group work reflects a range of work from organising and participating in Migrant interagencies to the provision of training and so on. As can be seen 1938 participated in this work. Training provided this year included upgrading or introducing services and individuals to improving their cultural sensitivity in working with new arrivals and humanitarian entrants as well as how to access resources like interpreters. Some of this work was undertaken in partnership with other services, especially health, aged and general welfare services. This also took place across the rural area that the MRC serves as well as the Newcastle and Hunter area.

In order to address gaps in services and to ensure that the MRC understands and is able to identify the issues facing migrants, the rural support project convenes, supports and participates in five multicultural interagencies in the central and far west as well as along the coast. One of these – the Hunter Rural Migrant Network has been very successful this year in promoting Migrant Services through a series of Expos at Salamander Bay (Port Stephens LGA), Muswellbrook and at Cessnock. The Port Stephens Expo was also listed as a Harmony Day function. Other interagencies that are supported by this project include the Hunter Migrant Disability Network, which participated in a very successful Carers day project at Hunter Valley gardens and the Migrant Aged services network.

The final area of work to which this project has addressed itself over the year has been to support other MRC projects. In particular support has been given to most projects but especially to the Community Visitor's Scheme in planning and development, the Drug and Alcohol Youth project with support in the provision of training on cultural competencies, the Families First training manual project with general advice and the Productive Diversity project with its development of a Conference for 2004 and the paper presented at the 2003 Diversity Conference.

Alex Burns

Annual Report 2003

Community Settlement Services Scheme Worker (CSSS) Level 2

(Funded by Department of Immigration and Multicultural Affairs)



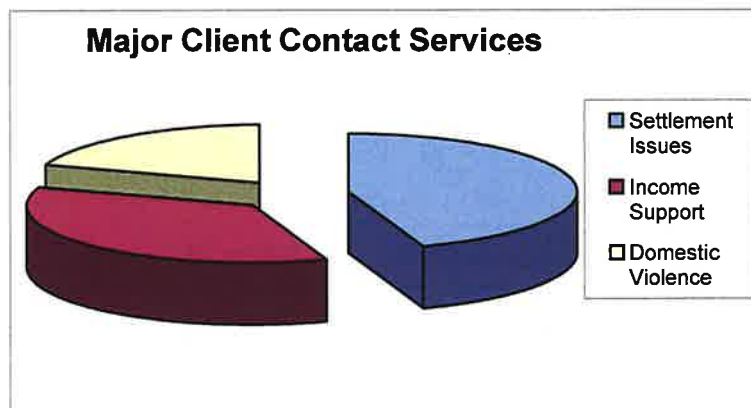
During this period the CSSS worker has worked with 373 individuals from 29 different backgrounds, which truly represents multicultural casework. As table 1 shows, the majority of clients were women 71% and 88 were new clients, 83 were humanitarian entrants (22%) The greatest number continued to be those aged between 25<55. and those who had been in Australia for less than 5 years (39 %).

Table1: Client Services

Client Characteristics												
Country of Birth/ Ethnic Group	Sex		Years in Australia			Age						
	Female	Male	Under 2 yrs	2-5 yrs	5+ yrs	0<16 years	16<25	25<55	55+ years	Humanitarian Entrant	First-time Client	Total Number of Clients
29	268	105	34	113	226	17	61	218	77	83	88	373

Figure 1.

Figure 1 shows the major issues / concerns presented by the client group. "Settlement Issues", "Income Support" and "Domestic Violence", were the significant emerging issues followed by Accommodation, Learning English and "Other Services" including enquiries about overseas pensions.



Group Work

The Japanese group continues to meet at MRC on regular monthly basis. Two courses took place with the support of Drug & Alcohol MRC Youth worker on " Save a Mate" for the Japanese group. Two courses about drug and alcohol issues were also arranged for Bosnian Youth.

Information sessions were also organised for the Japanese group regarding Centrelink payments and general enquiries. The MRC Families first worker and local HACC and CACP providers also gave information sessions.

The Cessnock Multicultural group continues to develop through outreach support. Information sessions were planned and held. Some members were linked and completed the 4 week Life Experience Counts course and a 5 week Computer course. The group also attended a "Think Smart " seminar organised in partnership with the Office of Fair Trading during its week-long campaign on its services.

Several other information sessions were organised during the year included Centrelink, TAFE, MRC's free Migration Agent, ECC Children's services and Mental Health.

Outreach work:

Regular weekly outreach services were provided to migrants in three different locations to reach those people where support services are difficult to access. These locations are: Singleton and Cessnock on each alternate Friday. Outreach services were provided at Raymond Terrace on every Thursday.

During this year three very successful Expos have been held at Salamander Bay, Muswellbrook and one at Cessnock. The Expos were organized by the Hunter Multicultural Workers Network, which the CSSS project convenes. This was a way of informing and reaching out to areas of the Hunter in order to better promote the range of services available locally. The aim of these Expos was to invite all service providers based in the LGA's as well as the community, to come along and meet the various Multicultural Services and become familiar with the types of assistance available for culturally and linguistically diverse people.

Port Stephens Expo was timely in that it took place on the day of National Harmony Day, which promotes the importance of people from all over the world living together in spirit of tolerance and harmony. Favorable outcomes were expressed by the 20 agencies involved as well as very positive feed back.

Regular networking and information sharing have been a large component of my work, and assistance was given to both government and non-government agencies to improve access and service to migrant communities. This project was also involved in a range of community events, training and special programs.

Miza Torlakovic

SKILLED MIGRANT PLACEMENT PROGRAM ANNUAL REPORT 2003

Funded by the Department of Education and Training



Key Performance Indicators

Full-time employment placements (<i>more than 6 weeks</i>)	30
Part-time employment placements (<i>more than 6 weeks</i>)	35
Work experience placements (<i>140 hours or over</i>)	30
Clients enrolled in training	70
New clients registered	72
Clients assisted with overseas qualifications	35

CLIENT EMPLOYMENT

Targets set by the Department of Education and Training in employment for SMPP clients have not only been met but also exceeded by the local program. This is seen as a culmination of preparing skilled migrants to become job ready and intervention by the SMPO in negotiating with employers and matching skills to vacancies. Employment gained by clients has been in all types of jobs including accountant and accounts clerical; computing professional; cleaner, kitchenhand and chef; security officer; hairdresser and beauty therapist; gardener; librarian; research assistant; manager; personnel officer; fire fighter; labourer and process worker; receptionist and administration officer; sales assistant and marketing specialist; teacher and community worker; and medical professional.

By far the greatest number of placements has been in the area of assistant nursing, mainly in aged care nursing homes. This has been identified as a key skill shortage in the local labour market where trained migrants are highly sought after because of their good work ethic and attitude to patient care. Therefore many migrants are being advised to train in Certificate III in Aged Care Nursing for which designated migrant funding is urgently needed.

CLIENT TRAINING

Four Skillmax courses ran continuously over the year in the upstairs training room at the Migrant Resource Centre. It was decided that part-time Skillmax classes might better suit the local client group, allowing greater flexibility for clients who are doing part-time work, other courses or who may have childcare problems. The part-time format began in July under a new casual AMES teacher, Kathy Patterson. She is a very experienced teacher with an extremely positive attitude and the new format seems to be working well, with even greater numbers of clients opting for Skillmax training. It is seen that the intensive job search training that Skillmax offers adds a great deal of value to the SMPP Program and to the achievement of departmental targets.

The Multicultural Education Unit of TAFE under Steve Georgopolous has worked together with the SMPP Program to organise courses in beauty therapy and nail technology to cater for a perceived need in the labour market and to draw on the skills and interests of our mutual clients.

The nail technology course commenced in March for one day per week with fifteen enthusiastic participants. This was followed by a beauty therapy course in July, with many of the same clients following on from the nail technology course.

CLIENT WORK EXPERIENCE

About thirty work experience placements have been sustained for 140 hours to enable them to become outcomes for the SMPP Program. About one third of work experience placements in 2003 have resulted in paid work for clients. Six of these paid work opportunities have been through Hunter Area Health in such facilities as the Mater Hospital, the Toronto Polyclinic and the John Hunter Pharmacy. Others have included an accountant at the Newcastle University, administration placements at Lake Macquarie Council and Department of Education and Training and a science teacher in the Catholic school system. These placements emphasise the pathway to employment that work experience can offer to our clients. It also exposes clients to an experience of workplace culture and local practices in their fields of expertise, giving them that much needed local Australian experience and referees that they can add to their resumes.

LINKS WITH COMMUNITY, GOVERNMENT AND BUSINESS ORGANISATIONS

In 2003 outreach services of the SMPP Program have been conducted at Wyoming Community Centre and Warner Vale Family Centre. The sessions have concentrated on job search skills and many of the participants have subsequently become individual clients of the SMPP Program who have been assisted with further training and work experience.

The Job Network has commenced a new contract period with many changes to the system including a renewed focus on mutual obligation in job seeking activities for those on Centrelink benefits. I have been very focused throughout the year in raising awareness amongst our clients of these important changes. I have also contacted many new job network providers who have taken up contracts in July 2003. Many clients have been referred to jobs advertised on the Job Network's Internet site and have been registered with the new and existing providers.

Several clients have been referred to the federally funded "Transition to Work" Program through Wesley Uniting Employment. This program provides financial assistance of up to \$400 to clients who have been out of the workforce for over two years either caring for children or the sick. This money can be used for retraining or any endeavour, which is judged by Wesley Uniting to be essential in their 'return to work' plan. For one of my clients, a beauty therapist from Taiwan, the program provided \$250 to the Vocational Training Board to cover the costs of the trade test at TAFE for recognition of her overseas trade qualifications as well as supplying \$150 for necessary equipment for preparation for the test.

On 3rd June I attended a forum in Sydney at the Office of Employment, Equity and Diversity on the Migrant Career Development Program and its implications for SMPP clients. The NSW Fire Brigade has raised some designated vacancies for migrants through this program. A local Spanish client, Pablo Lopez, was the only successful migrant to make it through the arduous selection process and training course and become a permanent member of the NSW Fire Brigade this year. This is a great 'good news' story for the local program and has been reported on in the Sydney press.

Throughout 2003 there has been meaningful networking taking place with the welfare workers and other staff at the MRC and the SMPP Program. All staff have been helpful in identifying potential candidates for Skillmax and the SMPP Program. Also several clients with small children, who have experienced difficulty in their family life, were referred to the Families First Project for assistance. I would like to thank all staff and also the Management Committee for their support and assistance in the implementation of SMPP programs.

CHRISTINE FOLLETT

PRODUCTIVE DIVERSITY IN THE WORKPLACE PROGRAM ANNUAL REPORT-2003 (1 November 2002 – 31 October 2003)

Funded by Department of Education and Training



The **Productive Diversity Workplace Program** (PDWP) was effectively managed in November and December by Lulu Tantos while the DIMIA Rural Evaluation Project was underway. The continuing strategies of awareness raising, knowledge and skills training, and implementation processes have progressed with some key results achieved listed below. Quarterly Productive Diversity Network meetings have been held all 4 regions while the regular newsletter "Diversity Works" has been produced in November, February, May and August. A booklet of regional success stories was also compiled this year, while excellent administrative assistance

has been provided by Annie Gawn.

Key initiatives:

- ⊕ Collection of rural and regional "Good News" stories from the four Productive Diversity Network areas. Some stories have been promoted in the newsletter; others have been added to the PDWP webpage.
- ⊕ Sydney Productive Diversity Network. This network has now changed its focus to that of a *working group*. It has had 3 meetings this year and administrative and clerical support is being provided by this program.
- ⊕ PDWP Website has had many additions: Good News stories, details of employers with a diversity focus, networking tips, links with the DIMIA skilled migrant database and network activities.
- ⊕ Newsletter registered with and regularly supplied to the National Library of Australia and the State Library of NSW.
- ⊕ Booklet on regional "Good News" stories compiled, registered as above and used as a marketing tool.
- ⊕ Diversity Management survey results were collated: few companies had policies in place on productive diversity but most were keen to sell to diverse markets. Recognition of Prior Learning was seen as the preferred way of assessing overseas skills.
- ⊕ A successful 'Harmony Day' breakfast was held in partnership with DIMIA in Newcastle in March.
- ⊕ Developed a link page on the Hunter's diverse workforce – this information is now on the Hunter Economic Development Corporation's website.
- ⊕ 2 training modules developed for use with TAFE, University students or HR managers.
- ⊕ Presentation given to University of Newcastle Graduate Diploma in Management students on productive diversity.
- ⊕ Presentations at 2 conferences in Sydney on outcomes from the 2002 DIMIA Rural Evaluation project.
- ⊕ Initial planning completed for 'Diversity Works' 1-day conference to be held in Newcastle in May 2004.

Presentations/Meetings: 2002 - 2003

MONTH	TOPIC	TARGET AUDIENCE	NOs.	LOCATION
December	Productive Diversity	Employers	24	Newcastle
February	Travel and P.D	Employers and service providers	12	Coffs Harbour
February	Using overseas skills	Business people (Rotary)	25	Coffs Harbour
March	Travel and P.D.	Students/service providers	22	Gosford
March	Harmony Day breakfast	Newcastle network	35	Newcastle
March	Travel and P.D.	Migrants/tourist operators	22	Bathurst
March	Business and Diversity	Business and professional women	35	Bathurst
April	Business and Diversity	Business and professional women	12	Lake Macquarie
May	DIMIA report	CSSS workers	30	Sydney
May	DIMIA report	AMES teachers	70	Sydney
May	Skills/qualification of migrants	Service providers	15	Bathurst
May	Travel and P.D.	Migrants/tourist operators	22	Orange
June	Migrants and Small Business	Migrant: students, business owners	28	Coffs Harbour
July	Migrant services, Productive Diversity	Business network	80	Lake Macquarie
July	Migrant services, Productive Diversity	Lions Club members	25	Newcastle
July	Travel and P.D.	Network members	29	Newcastle
October	Migrants and Small Business #2	Migrant: students, business owners	12	Coffs Harbour
October	Productive Diversity	Post graduate students	50	Newcastle

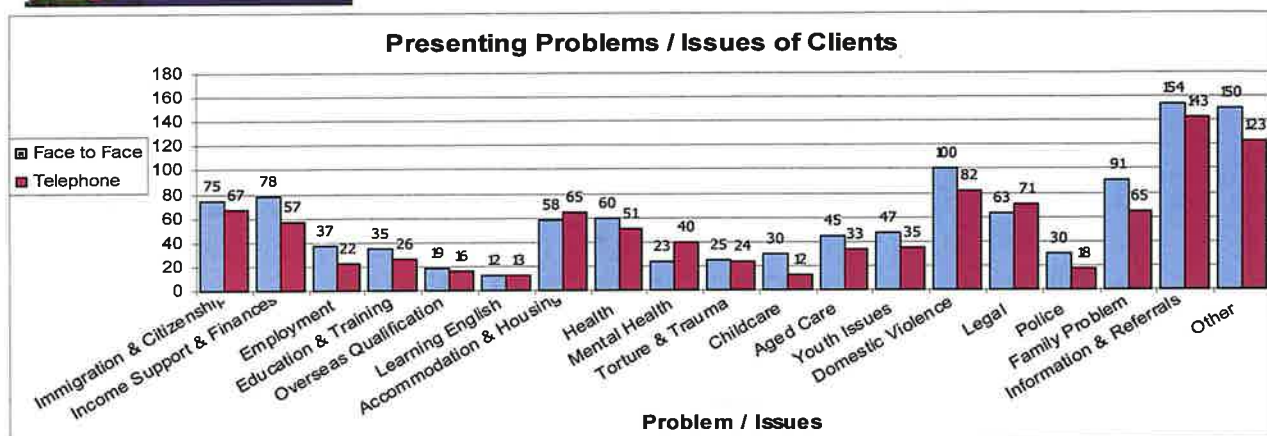
I was on leave in August and September 2003. Materials on the 2004 Conference were distributed to the Centrelink regional Conference, to the South West Program and to the Cultural Diversity conference in Melbourne in October. Many thanks in particular to Alex Burns who prepared and presented an excellent paper on my project to the Melbourne conference. Many thanks also to the wonderful staff who make this Centre such an enjoyable place to work.

Cathy Johnston
Program Coordinator.



Annual Report 2003
Filipino Welfare Service
(Worker was on leave for three and a half months)
Funded by the Department of Community Services

I am delighted to present my 11th report to the Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and the Hunter Region.



Client Statistics:

In 2003, I have assisted 251 people with a variety of needs /issues. One thousand and one hundred thirty two (1132) instances of face to face service and 963 instances of telephone assistance were provided to the community. As can be seen from the statistics, the service of information and referral offered to individual and families form a significant part of my work. This is followed by domestic violence, family problems, income and finances and immigration matters.

Other Include: social / emotional, language difficulties, filling out forms, supporting letters, interpreting and translations, taxation, electricity, telephone and water bills, gambling problems, separation /divorce, death / bereavement, harassment, discrimination, travel offences, infringement notices, compensation, relationship conflict outside of marriage, neighbourhood disputes, passport renewals, cultural information, transport, books, brochures and pamphlets about the Philippines

Information Sessions / Seminar / Outings

In cooperation and partnership with some agencies and some MRCs staff, during the year I have organized some information sessions and some outings for the community such as:

‘Feeling Good’ with the topics Well Being – Physical and Psychological, Good Coping Mechanisms, Good stress Management, Assertiveness and Steps to Enhanced Happiness; Information Session on Hunter Health’s Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services, Information Session on Budgeting Money, Gambling and other Financial Issues, Consultation on the Health Problems of

Filipinos and an Information Session on the Various Childcare Services offered to families.

During the Multicultural Health Week Celebration at the John Hunter Hospital I organized the Filipino Choir of Newcastle to represent the Filipino community.

There was also a visit by some members of the community to Myuna Bay Sports and Recreation Centre. during the Multicultural Open Day.

I have Liaised With The Following On Behalf Of Clients:

- ❑ Legal Aid; Centrelink; Legal Practitioners (Private); Real Estate Agents;
- ❑ Department of Housing; Probation & Parole Services;
- ❑ Women's & Children's Refuge Centres; General Practitioners (GPs);
- ❑ The Philippine Consulate Office; MRCs staffs; Police Service;
- ❑ Migrant Health Services; Hunter Community Legal Centre; Public Trustee;
- ❑ Telstra; Local Courts; James Fletcher Hospital; John Hunter Hospital;
- ❑ Mater Hospital; Department of Education; TAFE; and
- ❑ Aged Care Assessment Team (ACAT); Passport Office; etc.

Meetings, Seminars, Trainings, Etc.:

I took part in a wide range of meetings, seminars, trainings and information sessions including:

- ❑ TAFE Information Session; Community Forum on the Report of the Parliamentary Inquiry into Child Protection;
- ❑ DOCS Evaluation & Performance Indicators Reporting Meeting with Drug & Alcohol Multicultural (DAMEC) workers;
- ❑ Wallsend/ Toronto DV Committee Meeting; Port Stephens Expo;
- ❑ Meeting with a worker from Arafmi; Guardianship Tribunal Seminar;
- ❑ Stop DV Forum Day; Computer Training; Welfare Reform Forum;
- ❑ Multicultural Health Week Meeting w/ a Migrant Health worker; and
- ❑ Information Session for CALD families in Newcastle consultations (to & from)

Regular Activity:

Supervising the Filipino Social Group which meets every Friday at the MRC, the aim of which among others is to alleviate social isolation.

Other activities:

I attended or have been involved with the following:

- ❑ MRC staff meetings; MRC Caseworkers' meetings;
- ❑ Migrant Forum meetings; Domestic Violence Court Support Scheme; and
- ❑ Culturally And Linguistically (CALD) Advisory Group

Finally, I would like to thank my colleagues and the MRC Management Committee for their support.

Pet M. C. Kelly



CALD Service Delivery Project - Annual Report 2003

(Funded by NSW Department of Community Services)

The project was funded by a Families First initiative to enhance the cultural competence of relevant DoCS funded services to work with families from diverse cultural and linguistic backgrounds. It was funded for 6 months from May to November 2003 for 14 hours a week.

Objectives:

The project builds on a previous project which developed a Families First Access and Equity resource manual, "We Don't Have Any CALD Clients", by providing additional funds to make the manual more widely available in the Hunter, and to provide face to face training based on this manual to selected services working with young families in Port Stephens, Lake Macquarie and Newcastle.

Client Group:

In the previous project 40 manuals were targeted for CSGP services such as Family Support and SAAP services such as refuges. The current funding targeted a further 60 hard copies of the manual for:

- Newly funded Families First projects
- Hunter based projects that provide services to families with children aged 0-8
- DoCS funded Children's Services
- Neighbourhood Centres
- DoCS Community Service Centres
- Child and Family nursing staff

Promotion and Marketing:

A copy of the manual has been put on to the MRC website. The DoCS Learning and Development Unit is also interested in having the manual on their new website through a link to the MRC website.

Letters were sent to selected services offering them a manual and information on training. The 60 manuals were produced and delivered, mainly in person, to the targeted services. A further 28 requests for the manual were referred to the MRC website.

The manual was promoted at Multicultural Health Week and Lake Macquarie Migrant Services Expo. The Families First Learning and Development Strategy has a copy of the manual.

Training:

3 sessions on "Multicultural Awareness and Activities" were presented to child-care workers from DoCS funded Children's Services, with one session in Lake Macquarie, one in Newcastle and one in Maitland. The sessions were delivered in conjunction with the Ethnic Communities Council and were very well received by the 40 participants.

3 full-day Cultural Competency workshops were presented to services involved in Families First, including Family Support Services, Supported Accommodation Assistance Projects, Homestart, women's refuges, disability programs and Special Education. Attendances were disappointing, but evaluations from the 20 participants were very positive. The workshops were in Newcastle, Raymond Terrace and Maitland.

A training session was presented to the Neighbourhood Centre Forum.

It has been very satisfying to be able to round off and enhance the previous project, especially presenting the training based on the manual, and it has been a delight to be back at the MRC!

Pat Dring

PROBLEM GAMBLING SUPPORT PROJECT-ANNUAL REPORT 2003 - (July 2003 – November 2003)

Funded by Casino Community Benefit Fund

The aim of the Problem Gambling Support Project is to provide culturally appropriate and accessible services to culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) communities in dealing with problem gambling and related issues. The project has been in progress for four months, during which time a significant number of the project goals have been achieved.

General Promotion

To raise awareness of the project the following activities have been undertaken:

- Development of a project brochure, copies of which were sent to over 130 local multicultural services and groups and mainstream health and welfare services.
- Mail-out of a small project poster and brochures to all clubs in Newcastle and the Hunter, with a request that this information be displayed near other problem gambling support information.
- Media release to community newspapers in the Hunter, which resulted in an article in the Star newspaper in July.
- Liaison with mainstream and multicultural problem gambling services in Newcastle, Hunter and Sydney, including joining and attending meetings of the NSW Council on Problem Gambling.
- Arranging for the MRC to be added to a state-wide referral list which is sent to all problem gambling services in NSW.
- Promotion of the project by Pacific Islander caseworkers on community radio.
- Promotion of the project at various meetings including Multicultural Health Week, Centrelink Migrant Forum, Ethnic Communities Council HACC Coordinators meeting, Older Men's Well-being meeting, Hunter CALD Advisory Group meeting, Domestic Violence Awareness Day and Cessnock Multicultural Expo.
- Promotion has involved raising awareness of local mainstream problem gambling services and the Multicultural Problem Gambling Service (NSW), in addition to the MRC project.

Cultural Awareness Training for Problem Gambling and Related Services

Arrangements have been made for a cultural awareness training session to be provided by the MRC to the Newcastle and Hunter Financial Counsellors Association in February 2004. I am also exploring interest among problem gambling services, women's refuges and domestic violence services for a similar session to be held with these staff, early in 2004. This session will aim to explore the link between problem gambling and domestic violence, with particular reference to CALD communities.

Community Education

A significant part of the project has involved identifying opportunities for presenting CALD groups with information about problem gambling and services available. These sessions have aimed to both break down the stigma and shame associated with problem gambling and also to provide people with some practical ideas for getting gambling under control and/or supporting someone who has a gambling problem. Discussion in the sessions also involves:

- An outline of the difference between social and problem gambling;
- Signs and indications that someone may have a gambling problem;
- Reasons why someone might develop a gambling problem;
- What problem gambling counselling involves; and
- Distribution of written material in community languages.

The sessions are very informal and interactive, with opportunity for questions, comments and group discussion. In one session the issue of problem gambling was introduced under the heading of "budgeting and other financial issues", as this was thought to be a less confronting way to present the topic. In this instance the presentation was delivered by a financial counsellor from Lifeline Newcastle. To date 14 presentations have been made to approximately 380 people in the following groups:

Month	Group	Location	No.	Topics covered
Aug	Lake Macquarie Multicultural Friendship Group	Toronto	30	Brief introduction of project & services
Aug	Filipino Group	MRC	15	1 hour session on budgeting & problem gambling
Aug	Polish Day Care (Wed Group)	Broadmeadow	40	Brief introduction of project
Sept	Akebono (Japanese Group)	Broadmeadow	20	Brief introduction of project
Sept	Greek Day Care Centre	Hamilton	40	30 min session – overview of problem gambling & services
Sept	Italian Day Care Centre	Hamilton	40	20 min session – overview of problem gambling & services
Sept	Polish Day Care (Tues Group)	Broadmeadow	40	Brief introduction of project
Sept	Macedonian Day Care Centre	Broadmeadow	40	30 min session – overview of problem gambling & services
Oct	Maitland Multicultural Group	East Maitland	35	30 min session – overview of problem gambling & services
Oct	Global Connections Group	Rutherford	5	1 hour session – overview of problem gambling & services
Oct	Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre – Intermediate English Class	New Lambton	7	Brief introduction of project & services
Nov	Centrelink CALD clients on parenting payments	MRC	50	2 hour session – information about Centrelink, MRC services and problem gambling
Nov	Spanish Speaking Women	MRC	10	Brief introduction of project
Nov	Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre – Advanced English Class	New Lambton	10	Brief introduction of project & services

In November presentations will also be made to the Holy Apostles Greek Orthodox Day Care Centre, the Chinese Association and a Russian women's group.

Client Caseload

In September I attended a one-week gambling counselling training course in Sydney, presented by Wesley Mission and funded by the Casino Community Benefit fund. Since July, I have worked with three clients on a one-to-one basis to provide them with support in dealing with gambling problems. It is expected that this caseload may increase as awareness of the project increases. It is also anticipated that there may be an increase in CALD clients accessing mainstream problem gambling services as a result of community education and awareness raising activities.

Project Reference Group

The Problem Gambling Support Project is overseen by Violetta Walsh, Barbara Knorr (Multicultural Liaison Officer, Newcastle Mental Health) and Glen Rampton (Counselling Manager, Newcastle City Mission). I meet with this group bi-monthly to report on achievements and discuss strategies for the project.

Lisa Reardon

MULTICULTURAL FAMILY SUPPORT WORKER ANNUAL REPORT 2003

Funded by Department of Community Services



This year Multicultural Family Support provided 1120 occasions of service to 378 people, with an average of 32 clients per month. Of the clients assisted each month an average of 24 were on-going clients (ie had received assistance in previous months) and an average of 8 clients per month were new referrals.

Of the 1120 occasions of service, 673 were delivered face to face and 447 occasions of service were delivered to clients by telephone.

Clients assisted during the year included men, women, adolescents and children from the following 44 ethnic backgrounds:

COUNTRY	No. of clients	COUNTRY	No. of clients	COUNTRY	No. of clients
Argentina	17	Germany	3	Russia	1
Australia	20	Greece	2	Samoa	1
Austria	1	Honduras	7	Somalia	1
Bosnia	1	India	2	Spain	71
Brazil	2	Indonesia	1	South Africa	1
Chile	21	Italy	6	Sudan	1
China	3	Japan	8	Tahiti	1
Colombia	16	Macedonia	8	Thailand	3
Costa Rica	6	Mexico	39	Tunisia	1
Dominican Rep	3	New Zealand	1	Ukraine	1
El Salvador	6	Panama	6	Uruguay	6
England	6	Papua New Guinea	3	Venezuela	2
Fiji	21	Peru	40	Vietnam	9
Finland	2	Philippines	16	Zimbabwe	2
France	5	Poland	5		

CLIENTS NEEDS:

Issues presented by clients are shown in the following table.

Problem/Issue	No. of Instances	Problem/Issue	No of instances
Family/Parenting	253	Housing	74
Domestic Violence	73	Legal	74
Immigration	41	Isolation	110
Income Support	57	Language	113
Employment/Education	81	Other*	109
Health	135	TOTAL	1120

*Others includes grief and loss, settlement information and cultural information.

SERVICES PROVIDED:

Services provided to families and individuals are as follows:

Service Provided	No. of instances	Service Provided	No. of Instances
General Information	300	General Support	180
Counselling	211	Court Support	9
Advocacy	65	Filling Out Forms	58
Consultancy	40	Home Visits	39
Referrals	114	Agency Visits	31
Mediation	73	TOTAL	1120

GROUP WORK:

- Meetings of the Multicultural Women's Support Group were held monthly during July-December 2002, with 12-15 people attending each month. Despite strong interest in the group for the first six months, changing circumstances and time commitments of some of the key participants in the group meant that numbers became too small for meetings to be worthwhile. However, several participants have recently contacted the MRC and expressed strong interest in starting the group up again, and it is anticipated this will happen late 2003 or early 2004.
- The Spanish Speakers Women's Group met each month during the year, with an average of 10-12 participants at each meeting. The Spanish Speakers Women's Group continues to have strong interest, as well as several new members joining throughout the year.

MEETINGS & CONSULTANCY:

Consultancy and attendance at meetings, seminars, training and information sessions plays a very important role in order to provide quality Family Support Services. Cultural information and consultancy was provided to 21 community services providers during the year. Thirty one meetings were attended during the year, as follows:

- CALD-DOCS Advisory Committee (3 meetings)
- Caseworkers meeting (7 meetings in total)
- MRC staff meeting (5)
- MRC AGM
- Centrelink Migrant Forum (3)
- Multicultural Health Advisory Committee
- Newcastle Domestic Violence Court Support Scheme Meeting
- Save a Mate Workshop
- Truth Behind Islam Forum
- Refugee Week
- Family Support Services National Conference
- TAFE information session
- Healthy Kids Workshop
- Migrant Health Cancer Forum
- Critical Incident Stress Debriefing Training
- Families First Resource Manual Launch
- EDEMU Conference (for Spanish Speaking Women)

Report prepared by Lisa Reardon, for Marcela Sutcliffe who is on extended sick leave. We wish her a speedy recovery – MRC Staff and Management.

Multicultural Family Support Project - (Families First)

Annual Report 2003

Funded by Department of Community Services

During the 12-month period a total of 49 families have accessed this service from the Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas. Of this 18 families received assistance outside of 9 – 5 pm and during the weekends and public holidays.

Of all the 49 families who accessed the service either one or both parents were from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds.

During the 12 months period clients from 31 countries were assisted.

Types of issues presented:

Assistance Provided	Number of clients
Domestic Violence	12
Housing Issues	15
Legal Issues	4
Isolation	28
Child/mother with disability	19
Antenatal/postnatal needs	7
Home Visits	47

Figure 1: Types of issues presented:

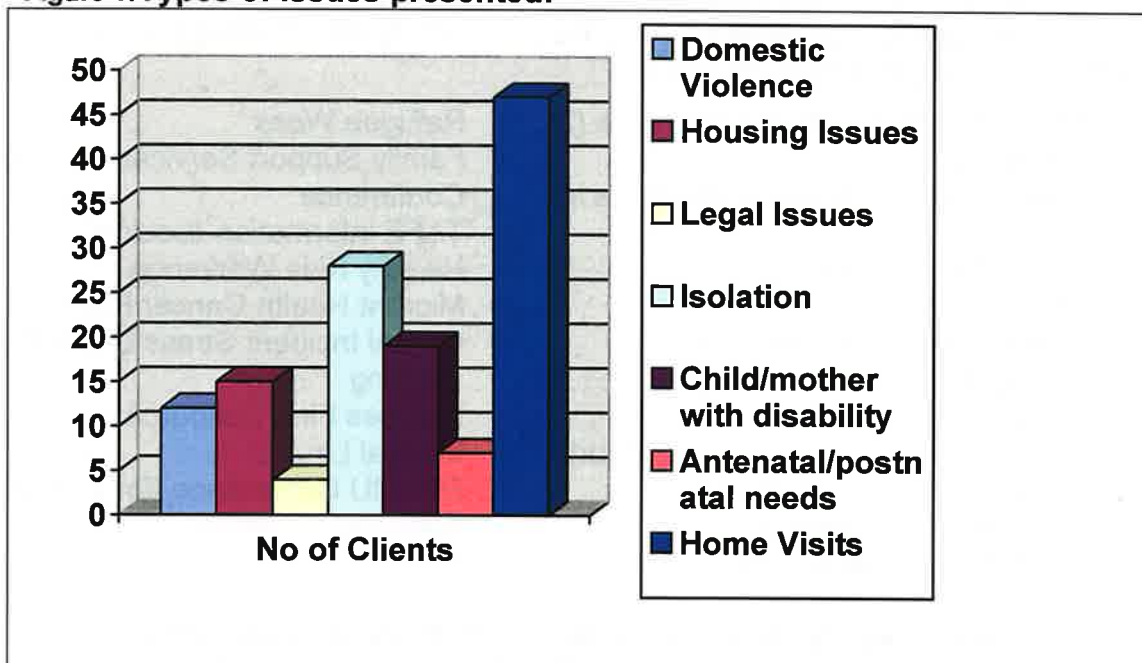
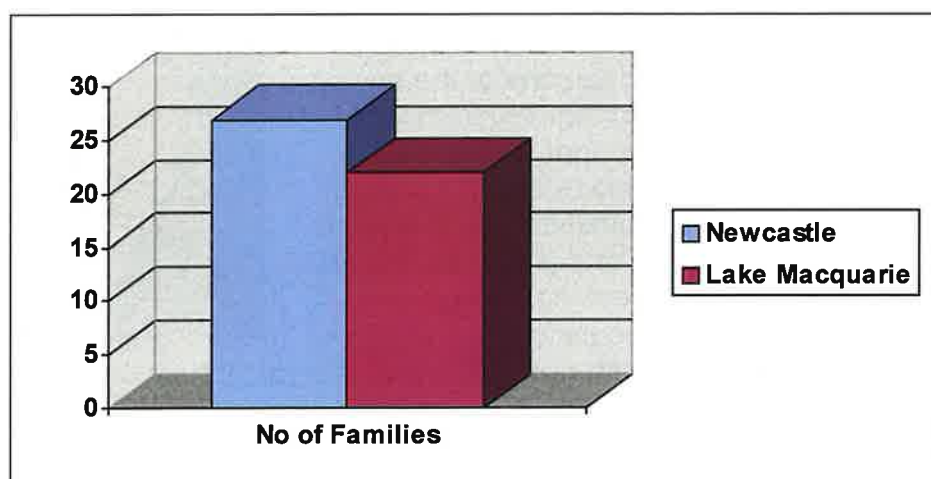


Figure 2: Clients from Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas:



Networking:

Worked in partnership with Special Education Newcastle University for children with disabilities.

Worked with Family Support Services, Home Start, Hunter Area Health, Migrant health, Ethnic Communities Council, TAFE, Eva's Project, Women's Housing, Newmacq Housing, DOCS, Legal Aid, Waratah Police and Department of Housing in linking clients and working together to provide assistance.

Case Management:

Clients accessed the service through self-referral, referrals through other services and from centre based referrals. Ongoing case management was provided with support through home visits, referral to other services, and/or accompanying clients to groups such as playgroups and nursing mothers groups.

Administration:

The flyer advertising the service has been translated in 15 languages. These flyers will be distributed to the relevant services to be given to CALD families.

It has been a very productive and a successful year for this new project with many positive outcomes. I would like to thank the Director, staff and the management committee for their support.

Devika Wijewardene

COMMUNITY AGED CARE PACKAGES 2003 ANNUAL REPORT

Funded by the Commonwealth Department of Health and Ageing

Community Aged Care Packages (CACP) are, and are likely to continue to be, one of the key elements of the Government's strategy for addressing the demographic reality of a rapidly ageing population. According to the 2001 Census figures, the non-English speaking background (NESB) population who are 65+



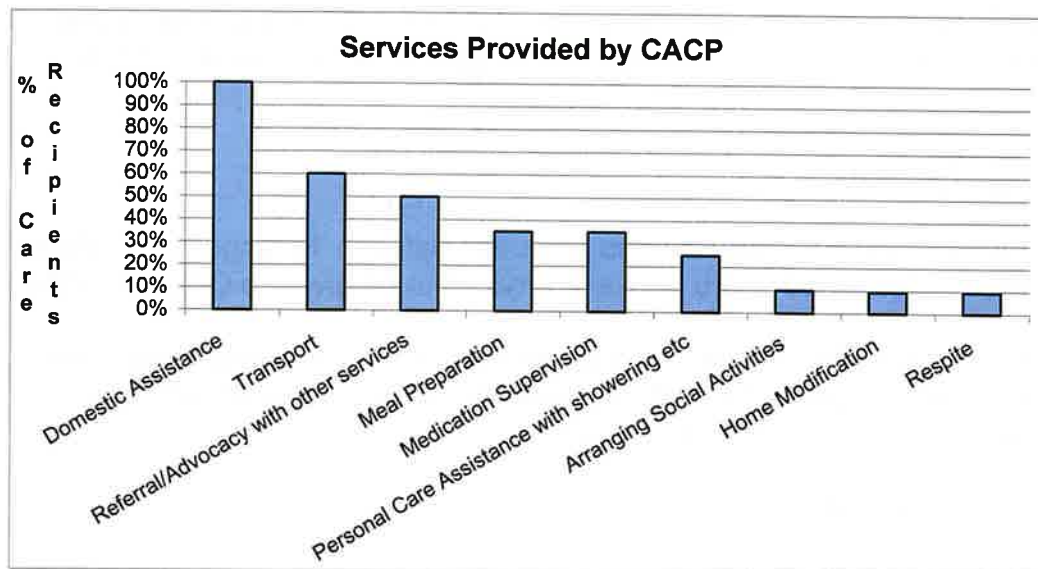
are increasing at a significantly greater rate than the general population. A feature of the Hunter NESB population is that a large proportion are the result of post WW2 migration, and many ethnic groups have a large percentage in the 65+ group; e.g. Ukrainian 86.4% Polish 64.3% Italian 54.6% Greek 39.8%

Also significant is the fact that there are many communities where the 75+ population is quite substantial e.g. Ukrainian over 80% Polish over 50%

The Multicultural CACP Project at the MRC is in its third year of successful operation and reflects the demographics outlined above – as the majority of care recipients are from Italian, Greek, Ukrainian and German backgrounds. In the past year two of our care recipients have moved to a hostel and one has passed away and one has voluntarily withdrawn– a turnover rate of 20%.

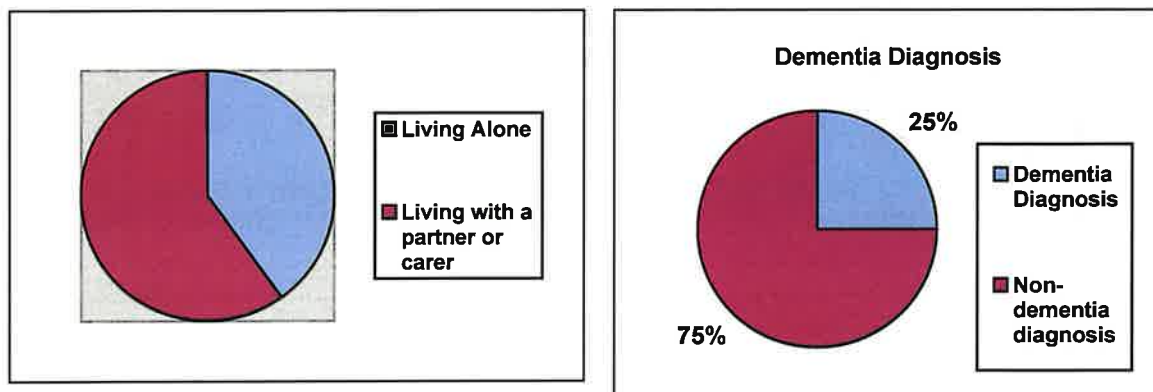
The CACP Project continues to provide a wide range of home based care and assistance to frail aged people from NESB who wish to remain living at home as long as possible.

Services Provided



Care Recipient's Profile

16 female and 4 male care recipients representing seven cultural backgrounds: Italian, Greek, Ukrainian, German, Sri Lankan, Russian and Macedonian



Model of Service Provision

The brokerage model adopted by the MRC has proven to be an efficient and effective means of service provision. Having a choice of a variety of providers enables us to better meet the cultural and linguistic needs of our care recipients.

Casework management Role

While the direct service provision is contracted out, there is also a substantial casework management component for the two part time Coordinators. This includes the ongoing monitoring of care recipient's welfare and changing needs as well as the more intensive assistance required by care recipients as a result of personal or health related crisis situations, such as hospital admissions, changing family circumstances and/or availability of other support mechanisms.

Training

The main focus of professional development of the Coordinators has been to enhance their skills in managing Quality Improvement. This will ensure that we meet and continuously improve the service provision and quality outcomes for our care recipients, as well as meet the more rigorous accountability framework that is likely to be introduced by the Department in the near future.

Coordinating CACP during the past year has been a satisfying, and at times, challenging role that has been made immeasurably easier through the invaluable, and much appreciated support and assistance provided by management and fellow colleagues at MRC and other organisations.

We wish you all a Safe and Happy Festive Season.

Sulu (Teleisia) Lolohea & Sue (Slavica) Hristov - Coordinators

COMMUNITY VISITORS SCHEME REPORT 2002/2003

Funded by the Department of Health & Ageing



This year is the 10th year of the MRC's Community Visitor Scheme and as in previous years continues to be a very busy project. Table 1 gives an indication of the work of the scheme and shows the number of visits made by our volunteers to the different nursing homes throughout the Lower Hunter. As will be noted from the table 731 visits were made.

Table 1: Visits by the Community Visitors Scheme to Lower Hunter Nursing Homes

Name of Nursing Home	Visits	Number of Visitors
ALLANDALE	18	2
BETHEDEN	98	4
BOLTON POINT	7	1
HAWKINS VILLAGE	23	2
KARA	33	1
KURRI MAS. HOSTEL	12	1
LINDSAY GARDENS	57	1
MAX KOLBE	80	5
MOUNT CARMEL	27	1
NARLA VILLAGE	12	1
OBAN	30	2
RED HEAD	5	1
ST. JOSEPH	40	1
TINONEE GARDENS	106	6
TORONTO	3	2
WALLSEND	135	5
WESCOTT	37	2
WESLEY	8	1
TOTALS	731	39

Although we received an increase in funding for our Visitors this year, and now are funded for 28 visitors, our visitors actually do much more. This is reflected in the table, which shows that our 28 Visitors do the work of 39 Visitors. This year we received an additional 5 Visitors because of the increase in demand.

The picture is more complex however, as not every Visitor does the same level of Visiting. For instance there are some Community Visitors who visit 3 or more different Nursing Homes in the Region. This is aided somewhat as we are also blessed with Volunteers who are able to speak several different languages. With this gift they can converse and visit several other Residents in the same Nursing Home.

Several problems have arisen this year, which we haven't faced in the past. As many of our Visitors are in their twilight years, the distance they may have to travel can be considerable. Thus we have to make sure that they are covered and protected when using their vehicles, especially with insurance. Further, as things have changed we also have to make sure that we continually raise the Visitor's awareness to changes in workplace requirements. Today we have to ensure that each Visitor has a solid understanding of the "formalities" in visiting as it is no longer just "Visiting old friends" even though this is how we want their visiting experience to be.

To meet the new challenges we have put more emphasis on our morning tea training sessions. We have had 3 training sessions so far this year with each focussing on a challenging area – Two of these were, "OH&S issues in our Visiting" and "Dementia".

We are also making use of other avenues to get information across with a visit in the near future to a movie on "Nursing Homes" being one of these.

I'd like to thank the Commonwealth Department of Health and Aging for its continued 10 years of support of our program, the staff at the many Nursing Homes the Visitors visit and especially our great and wonderful Community Visitors.

Ann Dupree

Community Visitors Scheme Photographs 2003



NESB YOUTH SUPPORT PROJECT

Annual Report 2003

Project period: March to September 2003

Target Group: Young people and communities of non-English speaking background and Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services Hunter Area Health Centre

Objective 1 - *To provide a targeted drug and alcohol prevention, education and harm minimization program to young people of non-English speaking background.*

Over the six-month project period six alcohol and other drug awareness sessions were provided to young people aged between 12 and 25 years. Two strategies were adopted to provide the awareness sessions. The first three sessions incorporated the Red Cross 'Save a Mate' (SAM) program and aimed at youth from specific ethnic communities and were held at the Migrant Resource Centre's premises in Hamilton. The SAM program was sought out to provide drug and alcohol awareness in a harm minimization format to young people of non-English speaking background (NESB). SAM is a 4½-hour drug education program and first aid course specifically designed for alcohol and other drug-related emergencies. SAM teaches participants to recognize the signs and symptoms of a drug overdose, and how to administer life-saving techniques. The program provides a general orientation to drug and alcohol issues, challenges myths, and promotes successful outcomes in drug and alcohol emergencies. The inclusion of this program in the NESB Youth Support Project was based on feedback from young people of NESB background who had participated in SAM as part of the Migrant Resource Centre's previous youth support project.

Young people from former-Yugoslav, Japanese and Pacific Islander communities participated in 3 SAM sessions. Feedback was very positive and indicated an appreciation of the CPR accreditation facet of SAM. The CPR accreditation appeared to be a significant draw card to young people's participation in the SAM sessions.

The final three sessions focused on groups of young people from diverse cultural backgrounds and aimed at providing drug and alcohol awareness in a sporting environment with a half hour awareness session followed by 1 hour of volleyball, these sessions were held at the Newcastle University Sport's 'The Forum'. The alcohol and other drug (AOD) awareness sessions were run by the Youth Support Project (YSP) officer and were informed by and based on the 'Drug sense : a harm reduction resource for senior secondary students' teaching resource by the Macarthur Drug & Alcohol Youth Project, along with NSW Health Fact Sheets and Australian Drug Foundation information. The three 30 minute sessions used Drug Sense activities and discussion to increasing awareness of physical and mental effects of alcohol, cannabis and tobacco use.

Objective 2 - *To increase awareness of Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services (Government and non-Government) among communities of non-English speaking background.*

Hunter Health Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services were promoted through a number of local ethnic communities newsletters and the Migrant Resource Centre's (MRC) 'Migrant Services Directory'. The service directory of Hunter

Health Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services were included in Tongan, Filipino, Samoan community newsletters as well as the Migrant Resource Centre's quarterly newsletter titled 'Ethnic Link'. The service directory was also included in the July update of the MRC's Migrant Service Directory which will be maintained and updated on a quarterly basis.

Another strategy used to promote Hunter Heath's Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services amongst the NESB communities was an AOD information display was held in the MRC's reception area for three weeks in July. The display included Hunter Heath's Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services information, brochures and service directory. (pictured left)



Drug and Alcohol Clinical Services Awareness sessions were arranged for the three following ethnic community groups:

- 1/6/2003 – Japanese community
- 27/6/2003 - Filipino community
- 3/7/2003 - Samoan community

Andrew Taylor, Clinical Nurse Consultant from Hunter Health Drug and Alcohol Clinical Service Unit, provided a presentation on these

services for both the Samoan and Filipino communities. The Japanese community participated in an information session conducted by the project officer. All communities were provided with information packages which included service brochures and other regarding AOD information, where possible information was provided in appropriate community languages.

Objective 3 - To increase access and equity for young people and communities of non-English speaking background by providing cultural competency training to Drug and Alcohol Services staff.

Three cultural competency-training sessions were held with Drug and Alcohol service providers from the Hunter area. One session was provided to the Samaritans Youth Service 'The Hub' on their premises at Newcastle West. Two sessions were provided to combined AOD service provider staff from the Hunter area.

The objective of the cultural competency training was to enhance and improve the skills of staff from government and non-government AOD service providers in working with migrants. The training also aimed at facilitating staff to be better able to serve migrant clients of cultural and linguistically different backgrounds. The training included a range of exercises and workshop activities and included handouts, guest speakers and overhead support as well as direct presentation. Francine Seeto, Project Officer from the Drug and Alcohol Multicultural Education Centre was a guest presenter at the two sessions held at the Migrant Resource Centre.

Carla Silva
NESB Youth Support Project Officer

CENTRE'S USAGE 2003

Baha'i Community of Newcastle	Bosnian Community of Newcastle
Estonian Community of Newcastle	Filipino Senior Citizens Group
Filipino Women's Group	Greek Macedonian of Newcastle (Pavlos Melas)
Greek Orthodox Holy Apostles	Hungarian Association
Korean Group	Latvian Community of Newcastle
Lettesi Group	Macedonian Brotherhood
Macedonian Youth Group	Nightingale (sub-group Lettesi)
Newcastle Theosophical Society	Newcastle Japanese Akebano Group
Samoa Women's Group	Samoa Catholic Community Choir
Slovene Association of Newcastle	School of Phillippines Studies
Sri Lankan Community	Spanish Speaking Dance Group "Tonatiuh"
Skillmax Group	Spanish Adult Group
Thai Women's Group	Tamil School
Tongan Community Choir	Tongan Women's Group

In addition the following multicultural groups have been accommodated

Families in Cultural Transition	Hamilton Multicultural Walkers Group
Home and Community Care	International Choir
Multicultural Women's Support Group	Newcastle & Hunter Ethnic Choral Society
South Pacific Islander Culture in Education (SPICE) Group	Domestic Violence Torture & Trauma Support Group
Hunter Community College – Life Experience Counts	Multicultural Dementia Support

The premises have also been utilized by interagency groups with a migrant focus/interest/sympathy

Amnesty International	Bohemian Outreach Society
Community Options NESB Committee	Centrelink Multicultural Access Forum
DOCS Culturally and Linguistically Diversity (CALD) Committee	Employment Opportunities
Fair Wear Committee	Hamilton Walkers
Hunter Ethnic Parents Teachers Association Community Languages	Hunter Community Council
Hunter NESB Disability Working Party	Pacific Islander Welfare Project Committee
Relationships Australia	Refugee Orientation Program Working Party
TACS Committee	United Nations Association

Centre Staff 2003



Lulu Tantos
Deputy Director/
Migration Agent



Carla Silva
Admin Officer



Mary Milevski
Admin Officer



Annie Gawn
PDW/SMPO
Assistant



Michael O'Sullivan
HPTACLS Project



Juanita Loli
Welfare Worker PIWC



Arlene Richards
Finance Controller



Tima Oto
Office Manager /
Refugee Support

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF
NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

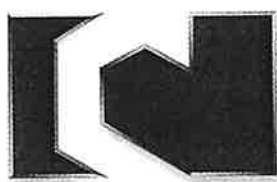
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Financial Report

For The Year Ended 30 June 2003



Cutcher & Neale
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS &
BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT CONSULTANTS



Cutcher & Neale

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION LIMITED

Financial Report For the Year Ended 30 June 2003

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**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

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DIRECTORS' REPORT

Your Directors present their report on the Company for the financial year ended 30 June 2003.

The names of the Directors in office at any time during or since the end of the year are:

Name	Position		Years Service
Henry Chan	Chairman	Member of Newcastle and Hunter Valley Chinese Association/Financial Advisor	15
Trudy Mills Evers	Director	Director of Migrant Health Service	18
Bill Samanowsky	Director	Ukrainian Community Representative	14
Ivan Klopčič	Director	President of Slovenian Association	7
Alina Kizewater	Director	President of Polish Association	12
Zoran Vasiljević	Director	Bosnian Community Representative	8
Sanja Young	Director	Tartar Community Representative	5
Melanie Larsen	Director	Filipino Community Representative (resigned 20/5/03)	8
Traje Trajanovski	Director	Macedonian Community Representative (resigned 20/11/02)	8
Fr Nicholas Zervas	Director	Greek Community Representative	4
Paul Mather	Director	Fellow of the Institute of Chartered Accountants	2
Mabor Kooc	Director	Sudanese Community (appointed 20/11/02)	1

Directors have been in office since the start of the financial year to the date of this report unless otherwise stated.

Principal Activities

The principal activity of the Company is the provision of welfare and information services

There were no significant changes in the nature of these activities during the financial year.

Operating Results

The net result of operations from ordinary activities for the year ended 30 June 2003 was a profit of \$50,859.

Review of Operations

Operating profit of \$50,859 was achieved and compares with a loss of \$14,531 achieved in 2002.

The Company operated successfully throughout the period applying grant funds for the purposes for which they were provided. All obligations and conditions of funding have been met.

Significant Changes in State of Affairs

In the opinion of the Directors, there has been no significant change in the state of affairs of the Company for the financial year.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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DIRECTORS' REPORT

After Balance Date Events

No matters or circumstances have arisen since the end of the financial year which significantly affected or may significantly affect the operations of the Company, the results of those operations, or the state of affairs of the Company in future financial years.

Future Developments

No information is included on the likely developments in the operations of the Company and the expected results of those operations.

Environmental Issues

The Company's operations are subject to environmental regulation under the law of the Commonwealth and State. The Directors are not aware of any breaches of the legislation during the financial year which are material in nature.

Meeting of Directors

During the financial period, 11 meetings of Directors were held. Attendances were:

	<i>Meetings</i>	
	No. Available	No Attended
Henry Chan	11	11
Trudy Mills Evers	11	5
Bill Samanowsky	11	8
Ivan Klopceic	11	8
Alina Kizewater	11	11
Zoran Valisjevic	11	7
Sania Young	11	8
Melanie Larsen	11	2
Traje Trajanovski	11	1
Fr Nicholas Zervas	11	6
Paul Mather	11	11

Indemnifying Officers or Auditor

Clause 83 of the Company's Articles of Association states:-

"Every member of the Management Committee, auditor, secretary and other office for the time being of the Centre shall be indemnified out of the assets of the Centre against any liability arising out of the execution of the duties of his or her office which is incurred by him or her defending any proceedings, whether civil or criminal, in which judgement is given under the Code in which relief is granted to him or her by the Court in respect of any negligence, default, breach of duty or breach of trust".

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DIRECTORS' REPORT

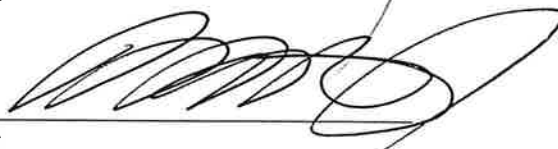
Directors' Emoluments

No Director has received or become entitled to receive, during or since the financial year, a benefit because of a contract made by the Company, with a Director, a firm of which a Director is a Member or an entity in which a Director has a substantial financial interest. This statement excludes a benefit included in the aggregate amount of emoluments received or due and receivable by Directors and shown in the Company's accounts.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of the Board of Directors:



Director



Director

Dated this 15th day of October 2003

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**INDEPENDENT AUDIT REPORT
TO THE MEMBERS OF
MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

Scope

We have audited the financial report of Migrant Resource Centre and Hunter Region Limited for the year ended 30 June 2003 as set out on pages 5 to 18.

The Company's Directors are responsible for the financial report. We have conducted an independent audit of this financial report in order to express an opinion on it to the Members of the Company.

Our audit has been conducted in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards to provide reasonable assurance as to whether the financial report is free of material misstatement. Our procedures included examination, on a test basis, of evidence supporting the amounts and other disclosures in the financial report, and the evaluation of accounting policies and significant accounting estimates. These procedures have been undertaken to form an opinion whether, in all material respects, the financial report is presented fairly in accordance with Accounting Standards and other mandatory professional reporting requirements and statutory requirements so as to present a view which is consistent with our understanding of the Company's financial position and performance as represented by the results of their operations and their cash flows.

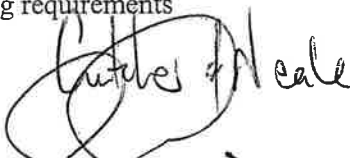
The audit opinion expressed in this report has been formed on the above basis.

Audit Opinion

In our opinion, the financial report of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited is in accordance with:

- (a) the Corporations Act 2001, including:
 - (i) giving a true and fair view of the Company's financial position as at 30 June 2003 and its performance for the period ended on that date: and
 - (ii) complying with Accounting Standards and the Corporations Regulations 2001; and
- (b) other mandatory professional reporting requirements

Signed at Newcastle on
16th October 2003
First Floor
25 Bolton Street
Newcastle 2300


CUTCHER & NEALE
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS
M.J. O'Connor C.A.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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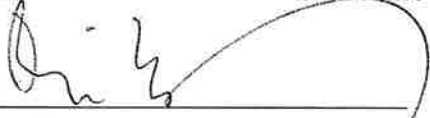
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DIRECTORS' DECLARATION

The Directors of the Company declare that:

1. the financial statements and notes, as set out on pages 6 to 18 are in accordance with the Corporations Act 2001:
 - (a) comply with Accounting Standards and the Corporations Regulations 2001; and
 - (b) give a true and fair view of the financial position as at 30 June 2003 and of the performance for the year ended on that date of the Company;
2. in the Directors' opinion, there are reasonable grounds to believe that the Company will be able to pay its debts as and when they become due and payable.

This declaration is made in accordance with a resolution of the Board of Directors.



Director



Director

Dated this  day of October 2003.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	Note	2003 \$	2002 \$
Revenues from ordinary activities	2	556,593	510,793
Employee benefits expense		(216,436)	(221,710)
Depreciation and amortisation expense	3	(19,727)	(19,691)
Administration expenses		(131,760)	(146,047)
Other expenses from ordinary activities	3	(137,811)	(137,876)
Profit/(loss) from ordinary activities		<u>50,859</u>	<u>(14,531)</u>
Total change in equity		<u>50,859</u>	<u>(14,531)</u>

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
AS AT 30TH JUNE 2003**

	Note	2003 \$	2002 \$
CURRENT ASSETS			
Cash assets	5	311,230	250,568
Receivables	6	76,621	43,529
Other	7	9,471	7,919
TOTAL CURRENT ASSETS		<u>397,322</u>	<u>302,016</u>
NON CURRENT ASSETS			
Plant & equipment	8	78,309	70,674
TOTAL NON CURRENT ASSETS		<u>78,309</u>	<u>70,764</u>
TOTAL ASSETS		<u>475,631</u>	<u>372,690</u>
CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Payables	9	39,378	3,471
Provisions	10	137,336	120,184
TOTAL CURRENT LIABILITIES		<u>176,714</u>	<u>123,655</u>
NON CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Provisions	10	32,461	33,438
TOTAL NON CURRENT LIABILITIES		<u>32,461</u>	<u>33,438</u>
TOTAL LIABILITIES		<u>209,175</u>	<u>157,093</u>
NET ASSETS		<u>266,456</u>	<u>215,597</u>
EQUITY			
Retained profits	11	266,456	215,597
TOTAL EQUITY		<u>266,456</u>	<u>215,597</u>

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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**STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30TH JUNE 2003**

	Note	2003 \$	2002 \$
CASH FLOW FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES			
Receipts from customers		514,061	515,801
Payments to creditors and employees		(435,477)	(569,992)
Interest received		9,440	8,281
Net cash provided by (used in) operating activities	17(b)	88,024	(45,910)
CASH FLOW FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES			
Purchase of plant & equipment		(27,362)	(18,475)
Proceeds from sale of plant & equipment		-	-
Net cash provided by (used in) investing activities		(27,362)	(18,475)
Net decrease in cash held		60,662	64,385
Cash at 1 July 2002		250,568	314,953
Cash at 30 June 2003	17(a)	311,230	250,568

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES

The financial report is a general purpose financial report that has been prepared in accordance with Accounting Standards, Urgent Issues Group Consensus Views, other authoritative pronouncements of the Australian Accounting Standards Board and the Corporations Act 2001.

The financial report has also been prepared on an accruals basis and is based on historical costs and does not take into account changing money values or, except where stated, current valuations of non-current assets. Cost is based on the fair values of the consideration given in exchange for assets.

The following is a summary of the material accounting policies adopted by the Company in the preparation of the financial report. The accounting policies have been consistently applied, unless otherwise stated.

(a) Income Tax

The Company is exempt from income tax under Section 50-30 of the Income Tax Assessment Act 1997.

(b) Plant & Equipment

Each class of plant and equipment is carried at cost less, where applicable, any accumulated depreciation.

Plant and Equipment

Plant and equipment are measured on the cost basis.

The carrying amount of plant and equipment is reviewed annually by the Directors to ensure it is not in excess of the recoverable amount from these assets. The recoverable amount is assessed on the basis of the expected net cash flows which will be received from the assets employment and subsequent disposal. The expected net cash flows have not been discounted to their present values in determining recoverable amounts.

Depreciation

The depreciable amount of all fixed assets are depreciated over their estimated useful lives to the Company commencing from the time the asset is held ready for use. Leasehold improvements are depreciated over the estimated useful lives of the improvements.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)**

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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES (cont'd)

The depreciation rates used for each class of depreciable assets are:

Class of Asset	Average Depreciation rate
Leasehold improvements	14.3 to 20% PC
Equipment	10% to 40% DV
Motor vehicles	22.5% DV

(c) Employee Entitlements

Provision is made for the Company's liability for employee entitlements arising from services rendered by employees to balance date. Employee entitlements expected to be settled within one year together with entitlements arising from wages and salaries and annual leave which will be settled after one year, have been measured at their nominal amount. Other employee entitlements payable later than one year have been measured at the nominal value.

Employee entitlements are calculated for each employee from the first day of employment, so that an accurate charge can be allocated to each grant.

Contributions are made by the Company to employee superannuation funds and are charged as expenses when incurred.

(d) Cash

For the purpose of the statement of cashflows, cash includes:

- cash on hand and at call deposits with banks or financial institutions, net of bank overdrafts; and
- investments in money market instruments maturing with less than 14 days to maturity.

(e) Revenue

Revenue from the rendering of a service is recognised upon the delivery of the service to the customers.

Interest revenue is recognised on a proportional basis taking into account the interest rates applicable to the financial assets.

All revenue is stated net of the amount of goods and services tax (GST).

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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES (cont'd)

(f) Goods and Services Tax (GST)

Revenues, expenses and assets are recognised net of the amount is GST, except where the amount of GST incurred is not recoverable from the Australian Tax Office. In these circumstances the GST is recognised as part of the cost of acquisition of the asset or as part of an item of the expense. Receivables and payables in the statement of financial position are shown inclusive of GST.

(g) Comparative Figures

Where required by Accounting Standards comparative figures have been adjusted to conform with changes in presentation for the current financial year.

(h) Administration Fees

Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited charge each grant as set out in Note 1 (i), an administration fee at commercial rates. Where the grant is unable to remit payment to Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited this amount is shown as a bad debt or provision for doubtful debts where applicable.

(i) Affiliated Grant Activities

Affiliated grant activities of the Company have been excluded from the financial report. These activities are:

- Community Visitors Scheme
- Family Support
- Filipino Welfare Project
- Community Settlement Service Scheme I
- Community Settlement Service Scheme II
- Special Migrant Placement Officer
- Rural Information Campaign
- Casino
- Immigration Advice and Application Assistance Scheme
- Community Aged Care Packages
- Refugee Housing
- Families First Cald Worker

(j) Grant Contribution

Amounts received from affiliated grants that are unable to pay the allocated administration charge and long service leave contribution at balance date are written off. This amount is raised as a grant contribution in Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited.

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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003 \$	2002 \$
NOTE 2 REVENUE		
Operating activities		
- Grant funds	300,068	320,159
- Administration fee received	204,572	176,661
- Interest received – other persons	9,440	8,281
- Other revenue	42,513	5,692
Total Revenue	<u>556,593</u>	<u>510,793</u>

NOTE 3 PROFIT FROM ORDINARY ACTIVITIES

Profit from ordinary activities has been determined after:

(a) Expenses

Depreciation of non current assets

- plant and equipment	<u>17,005</u>	<u>16,895</u>
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Amortisation of non current asset

- leasehold improvements	<u>2,722</u>	<u>2,796</u>
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Remuneration of auditor

- audit	<u>6,389</u>	<u>5,400</u>
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- other services	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
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	6,389	5,400
--	-------	-------

Rental expense on operating lease

- minimum lease payments	76,965	70,826
--------------------------	--------	--------

Bad and doubtful debts

- trade debtors	-	75
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- grant debtors	<u>54,457</u>	<u>60,847</u>
-----------------	---------------	---------------

Total bad and doubtful debts

	54,457	60,922
--	--------	--------

Administration cost

	-	728
--	---	-----

	<u>137,811</u>	<u>137,876</u>
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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003	2002
	\$	\$

NOTE 4 DIRECTORS' REMUNERATION

(a) Directors Remuneration

Income paid or payable to all Directors
of the Company

- -

Number of Company Directors whose
income from the Company was within
the following band:

\$0 - \$9,999

- -

The names of Directors who have held office
during the financial year are:

Henry Chan	Trudy Mills Evers
Bill Samanowsky	Ivan Klopac
Alina Kizewater	Zoran Valisjevic
Sania Young	Melanie Larsen
Traje Trajanovski	Fr Nicholas Zervas
Paul Mather	

NOTE 5 CASH

Cash at bank	153,816	101,072
Deposits at call	157,414	149,496
Refugee Housing account		-
	311,230	250,568

NOTE 6 RECEIVABLES

Trade debtors	97,486	59,718
Provision for loss on administration fees	(20,865)	(31,537)
	76,621	28,181
Other debtors	-	15,348
	76,621	43,529

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003 \$	2002 \$
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NOTE 7 OTHER ASSETS

Prepayments	9,471	7,919
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NOTE 8 PLANT & EQUIPMENT

Leasehold improvements – at cost	36,532	36,532
Less: accumulated amortisation	30,470	27,748

	6,062	8,784
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Equipment – at cost	122,219	115,721
Less: accumulated depreciation	97,961	90,442

	24,258	25,279
--	--------	--------

Motor vehicles – at cost	64,213	43,349
Less: accumulated depreciation	16,224	6,738

	47,989	36,611
--	--------	--------

Total Plant & Equipment	78,309	70,674
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Movements in carrying amounts

Movements in the carrying amount for each class of plant and equipment between the beginning and the end of the current financial year.

	Leasehold Improvements	Equipment	Motor Vehicles	Total
Balance at the beginning of the year	8,784	25,279	36,611	70,674
Additions	-	6,498	20,864	27,362
Depreciation and amortisation expense	2,722	7,519	9,486	19,727
Carrying amount at the end of the year	6,062	24,258	47,989	78,309

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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003	2002
	\$	\$
NOTE 9 PAYABLES		
Trade creditors	22,332	3,471
Grant Funds Carried Forward – Core Grant	17,046	-
	39,378	3,471

NOTE 10 PROVISIONS

CURRENT

Employee entitlements	137,336	120,184

NON CURRENT

Employee entitlements	32,461	33,438

(a) Aggregate employee entitlement liability	169,797	153,622
(b) Number of employees at year end	18	18

NOTE 11 RETAINED PROFITS

Retained profits at the beginning of the financial year	215,597	230,128
Net profit/(loss) attributable to members of the Company	50,859	(14,531)
Retained profits at the end of the financial year	266,456	215,597

NOTE 12 COMPANY DETAILS

The registered office and principal place of business is:

8 Chaucer Street
HAMILTON NSW 2303

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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003	2002
	\$	\$

NOTE 13 CAPITAL & LEASING COMMITMENTS

(a) Operating Lease Commitments

Non-cancellable operating leases contracted
for but not capitalised in the financial report

Payable

- not longer than 1 year	90,978	90,978
- longer than 1 year but not longer than 5 years	159,212	250,190
	250,190	341,168

The property is a non-cancellable lease with a five-year term, with rent payable monthly.

NOTE 14 MEMBERS' GUARANTEE

The Company is limited by guarantee. If the Company is wound up, the articles of the Company state that each Member is required to contribute a maximum of \$10 each towards meeting any outstanding obligations of the Company. At 30th June 2003 the number of Members was 69 (2002 – 69)

NOTE 15 SEGMENT REPORTING

The Company operates in the services industry wholly within Australia.

NOTE 16 FINANCIAL INSTRUMENT

(a) Interest Rate Risk

The financial assets and liabilities subject to interest rate risk are:

Bank Accounts

The Company's bank accounts earn interest at the market variable rate.

Short Term Deposits

The Company's term deposits earn interest between 5.55% and 4.10%.

All other financial assets and financial liabilities are not subject to interest rate risk as they are non-interest bearing.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003	2002
	\$	\$

NOTE 16 FINANCIAL INSTRUMENT (cont'd)

(b) Credit Risk

The credit risk on financial assets of the Company which have been recognised on the balance sheet, is the carrying amount net of any provision for doubtful debts.

(c) Net Fair Value of Financial Assets and Liabilities

The Company's financial assets and liabilities included in the balance sheet are carried at amounts that approximate net fair value.

NOTE 17 STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS

(a) Reconciliation of Cash

Cash at the end of the financial year as shown in the statement of cashflows is reconciled to the related items in the statement of financial position as follows:

Cash at bank	153,816	101,072
Cash on deposit	157,414	149,496
	311,230	250,568

(b) Reconciliation of cash flow from operations with profit from ordinary activities

Profit/(loss) from ordinary activities	50,859	(14,531)
Non-cash flows in profit from ordinary activities:		
Depreciation and amortisation	19,727	19,691
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
(Increase) / decrease in receivables	(33,092)	13,289
(Increase) / decrease in prepayments	(1,552)	(600)
Increase / (decrease) in trade creditors and accruals	18,861	(22,247)

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**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003	2002
	\$	\$
NOTE 17 STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS (cont'd)		
Increase / (decrease) in provisions	16,175	37,130
Increase / (decrease) in grant funds carried forward	17,046	(78,642)
Cash flow from operations	88,024	(45,910)

**COMPILATION REPORT
TO MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE
AND HUNTER REGION LIMITED**

Scope

On the basis of information provided by the Directors of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited, we have compiled in accordance with APS 9 'Statement on Compilation of Financial Reports' the following;

1) Detailed Statement of Financial Performance

of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited for the period ended 30 June 2003.

The specific purpose for which the above detailed financial reports have been prepared is to provide private information to the Directors and Members. Accounting Standards and UIG Consensus Views have been adopted in the preparation of the above detailed financial reports.

The Directors are solely responsible for the information contained in the above detailed financial reports and have determined that the accounting policies used are consistent with the financial reporting requirements of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited constitution and are appropriate to meet the needs of the Directors and Members of the Company.

Our procedures use accounting expertise to collect, classify and summarise the financial information, which the Directors have provided into the detailed financial reports. Our statutory audit procedures do not include verification or validation procedures over allocations within the above detailed financial reports and accordingly no assurance or opinion is expressed as to their accuracy.

To the extent permitted by law, we do not accept liability for any loss or damage which any person, other than the Company, may suffer arising from any negligence on our part. No person should rely on the above detailed financial reports without having an audit or review conducted upon them.

The above detailed financial reports were prepared for the benefit of the Directors and Members of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited and the purpose identified above. We do not accept responsibility to any other person for the contents of the special purpose financial report.

1st Floor
25 Bolton Street
NEWCASTLE


CUTCHER & NEALE
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS


M. J. O'Connor
Partner
14 October 2003

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED (A COMPANY LIMITED BY GUARANTEE)
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**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003	2002
<u>Income</u>		
Administration Fees	204,572	176,661
Donations received	1,013	968
Grants received	317,114	320,159
Less Carried forward to next year	(17,046)	-
Interest received	9,440	8,281
Interpreting fee	3,100	-
Membership Fees	162	535
MS direct migration	1,040	2,520
Photocopying	542	851
Contribution to expenses	36,154	-
Sundry	503	818
Total Income	556,594	510,793
<u>Expenses</u>		
Administration fees	1,696	-
Advertising	2,158	1,256
Audit and accounting fees	6,389	5,400
Bad debts written off	-	75
Bank charges	384	448
Catering, function	2,963	2,565
Cleaning	7,449	5,858
Computer expenses	10,644	2,842
Consulting	480	-
Depreciation and amortisation	19,727	19,691
Donations	130	260
Electricity	4,907	5,315
Grant Contribution	65,129	29,310
Insurance	7,847	5,833
Immigration booklets	820	1,300
Interpreting fees	922	2,700
Library	1,421	930
Licence fees	399	548
Photocopier expenses	10,114	10,205

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
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**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2003**

	2003	2002
Office furniture	-	684
Office supplies	2,326	8,042
Postage	7,247	6,558
Printing and Stationery	6,737	7,728
Provision for loss on administration fees	(10,672)	31,537
Rent	76,965	70,826
Rent outgoings	13,068	11,889
Repairs and Maintenance	335	1,085
RGH transfer	-	25,567
Security	657	-
Seminar and training	1,363	2,669
Staff amenities	2,732	500
Subscriptions and membership	328	620
Sundry	-	728
Telephone	26,950	28,136
Travel	1,165	988
Wages	216,436	221,710
Workers Compensation	16,519	11,521
Total Expenses	<u>505,735</u>	<u>525,324</u>
Operating profit/(loss)	<u><u>50,859</u></u>	<u><u>(14,531)</u></u>